Portfolio of Evidence

WOMEN WHO LEAD

Dear Participant

YOUR PORTFOLIO OF EVIDENCE (POE)

This document is the electronic version of your POE and holds the key to unlocking your POE.

You may well ask 'What is my portfolio of evidence?'

It is your learning guideline, it will be your guide when preparing your deliverables, but more importantly, it will help you to measure your own learning and development.

These projects and its deliverables are captured in this electronic file to make your life easier and guide you to completing the programme successfully. The file is divided into the four project sections and contains documentation that is also included in your learning file or handed to you during a session as well as emailed to you for ease of use (in case of MS Teams programmes), print and completion (should you wish to work on hardcopy). You do not hand in the hardcopies but the completed word document or scan that you PDF in an integrated folder.

Each section introduces the project and provides information on the deliverables for successful completion as well as templates and guidelines. Remember that this is a leadership development programme in which you need to demonstrate self-management and it will not be the role of facilitators to 'check-up' on your progress on projects. They will advise and clarify where required and act as 'master mentors' to you in completing your projects. At the end of the programme i.e. after the presentation to your executive team, you will email the portfolio to your facilitators for assessment and moderation. Please use the column in the content checklist to indicate which deliverables are contained in your portfolio.

We trust that you find this helpful and that you not only complete all the projects, but also enjoy doing so. More importantly, however, our wish is that the completion of each activity will bring you a step closer to realising the fundamental best you.

Kind regards

René

Prof. René Uys
Director
thinking fusion AFRICA

PARTICIPANT EVALUATION

Participant information	
Name of participant	
Identity number	
Contact number	
Organisation	
Facilitator	

Evaluation of Participant by Facilitator		
Attended required number of days:	Yes	No

%	<50 Fail	%	< 65% Below standard	%	65-74% On standard	%	> 75% Above standard

Facilitator signature: Date:

I CONFIRM/ADJUST the recommendation of the facilitator:

Moderator

Name: Signature: Date:

SUBMISSION OF PORTFOLIO OF EVIDENCE

1. You submit your POE as a single PDF document on a date agreed upon on the last day of the programme.

2. We regard plagiarism in a very serious light. Both participants will forfeit their certificates in the event of any part or the whole of the POE being a copy of other participants work.

3. The Personal and Professional Development Plan needs to be signed in person on hardcopy and scanned into the POE. No electronic signatures will be accepted.

4. https://www.talkhelper.com/pdf-converter/ is a tool that you can use to stich your POE into one document again after insertion of originally signed documents.

5. Please, do **NOT** submit your POE in parts. It will be sent back to you if separate pages are submitted.

PORTFOLIO OF EVIDENCE – CHECKLIST

Project ME: My personal and leadership journey		Mark	Included
1.	**Learning through reflection**		
1.1	Consider the following statements and answer them honestly in your journal: Write a statement describing your best self, write a life statement that defines who you are and where you are going, write down how you think people see you. Now, write down how you see yourself. Transfer to your POE.	15	
2.	**Leadership inventory reflection and areas to build on and develop**		
2.1	Leadership inventory reflection	20	
2.2	Personal Development Plan, signed by leader	30	
3.	**Emotional intelligence**		
3.1	Capture what you have learnt and plan to actively undertake	15	
3.2	Give feedback on one instance where you implemented EQ and what feedback you received	10	
4.	**Six leadership style radar chart and development needs**		
4.1	Include the radar chart	5	
4.2	Reflection on six leadership styles- areas for nurturing, development and mediation	15	
5.	**Transforming myself as follower**		
5.1	Self-assessment on own ability as follower	10	
5.2	Transform the leader-follower relationship by transforming yourself	30	
6.	**Sources of power**		
6.1	How do you capitalise and further build on your positive sources of power	15	
6.2	How do you develop your weak sources of power and reduce its negative impact	15	
7.	**Identity**		
7.1	Completed identity framework (your own) and logo	15	
7.2	What will you do to ensure you authentically live your personal Identity, professionally and personally?	15	
7.3	Which challenges might negatively impact living your authentic identity?	10	
7.4	Capture ONE measure you will put in place to ensure you stay true to your personal identity	10	

8.	DISA	Mark	Included
8.1	Extract your strongest DISA behaviours and two actions you will take to strengthen these even further.	15	
8.2	Extract your weakest DISA behaviours you need to develop most and four actions you will take.	15	
8.3	After sharing preference with team, ask your team to provide feedback on improvements noticed and capture this feedback in your POE.	15	
9.	**My personal commitment to diversity**	20	
10.	**Letter to yourself as your own best friend.**	15	
11.	**Ikigai**		
11.1	Consider which one or more of the four scenarios best describes your current existence, and why this is the case	10	
11.2	Consider the four areas of passion, profession, vocation and mission and what you could do in or all of these areas to make your 'reason for being' more meaningful. Use these reflections to inform your personal kaleidoscope	10	
12.	**Ethics**		
12.1	Ethical Orientation questionnaire	5	
12.2	Reflect on your results and capture your insights.	15	
12.3	What Impact does your Ethical approach have on decision making as a team leader?	10	
12.4	What impact does your Ethical approach have on decision making as a follower?	10	
12.5	Capture one incident of Ethics of justice and ONE incident of ethics of care which you were part of in your team	10	
13.	**Essay on development as an authentic leader**	20	
14.	**Transactional analysis**		
14.1	Identify which EGO state you typically engage in when interacting with: junior female followers, male senior leaders, women in leadership roles, your leader, followers in general	20	
14.2	How will you change your typical ego states above to engage in an Adult state in future?	10	
15.	**Communication**		
15.1	Identify which TWO tips you will apply to improve your verbal communication	10	
15.2	Share this with your team and ask feedback from your team when they witness improved communication by you	10	
16.	**Change**		
16.1	Observe change in your personal and work environment and identify the type of change you are experiencing, identify your initial response/concerns/ emotions and be aware of where you get stuck on the cycle and why. Capture at least one such an incident	20	

Project YOU: Leading through coaching		Mark	Included
1.	What was the initial response of the coachee? What were your expectations in terms of this meeting, and were they met? Identify possible concerns that might negatively impact the relationship. Be aware of the impact of your own expectations. Capture at least ONE concern in your journal and transfer this to your POE.	10	
2.	**Coaching agreement:**		
2.1	A completed agreement with an individual specifying the focus of coaching (signed by both)	20	
3.	**Progress report:**		
3.1	A progress report half-way through programme (Behaviour changes related to personality types and feedback from you and your coachee)	30	
4.	**Final coaching report:**		
4.1	A joint report by coach and coachee on the period of engagement, referring to a number of aspects, e.g. EI and listening skills	30	
Project US: Repositioning myself with my team & creating psychological safety			
1.	**Aspects of a culture**		
1.1	Identify the five most important elements that require change in your team to create psychological safety. Share this and agree to it.	10	
1.2	Agree the actions and changes required by you as leader of this team.	10	
1.3	Changes that should be made in the rest of your organisation to assist your team.	10	
1.4	Identify what you will pay special attention to in order to assist your team and the organisation to reach the desired state, psychological safety and live the organisation vision and purpose.	20	
2.	**Psychological safety**		
2.1	Leadership behaviours – write a short paragraph on each indicating how you:		
2.1.1	Became a visible and present leader	5	
2.1.2	Became a brand ambassador (lived the brand)	5	
2.1.3	Articulated the organisations visions to your team	5	
2.1.4	Lived the leadership behaviours	5	
2.1.5	Created Psychological Safety (refer 2.2 for your project inclusion)	5	
2.2	Individual psychological safety Project		
2.2.1	Title	5	
2.2.2	Project purpose	10	
2.2.3	Actions planned and taken	10	
2.2.4	Deliverables	10	
2.2.5	How experienced by followers	10	
2.2.6	Feedback by followers	10	

3.	Biases	Mark	Included
3.1	Refer to the Strategies contained in the articles "What works for women at work Maternal Wall Bias" and "What works for women at work Tightrope Bias" and identify strategies that you will employ, capture in your journal and POE the team advantages as well as your strategies.	15	
4.	**Communication**		
4.1	Presentation of your learning to your own team	40	
4.2	Team evaluation forms	10	
5.	**High-performance Individual assessment of team members**		
5.1	Include the 'HIGH-PERFORMANCE INDIVIDUAL ASSESSMENT OF TEAM MEMBERS' document of all your followers in your POE	10	
5.2	After assessing your full team, identify patterns in attributes, dimensions and categories common to all low or all high performers. Present these patterns to your team and agree with them the actions that will be included in your team development plan. Include the plan in your POE	20	
6.	**Joint accountability**		
6.1	Reflect on relationships, trust and candour within your team. Capture in your journal the actions that you will take as follows: My team leadership and team strengths that I will use more to improve on the above, My leadership and team deficiencies that I will share with my team and start doing something about	20	
7.	**Team development**		
7.1	Completed form	10	
7.2	Team development insights, learning and agenda	20	
8.	**Workstyles**		
8.1	Meet with your team and discuss the work style concept. Hand them a copy of the article. Share your own work style, ask them to identify their personal work styles for discussion at a separate meeting, at this meeting capture the team profile and debate your insights as well as how you will use it as a team	20	
9.	**Identity**		
9.1	Team identity and logo	15	
9.2	Reflection on team identity	15	
10.	**Strategy**		
10.1	Assessment 3, include the final page (my priorities and actions) as well as your final self-assessment radar chart	20	
10.2	Include the feedback you received from your team and how you will be responding to it.	15	

Project WE: 'Dissolving' complexity			
1.	**Presentation** – include the presentation of the project you participated in in your POE.	30	
2.	**Leadership challenge** – indicate the leadership challenge brough about by the 'messy' problem and what leadership challenges are faced by implementing the proposed 'solution'.	10	
3.	**Leadership pledge** – share your leadership pledge with regards to implementing and applying what you have learnt.	10	
4.	**Design thinking**		
4.1	Identify a design thinking project that your organisation requires, then build the foundation of a design thinking project using the template provided.	15	

PROJECT ME: MY PERSONAL AND LEADERSHIP JOURNEY

Zone of influence: self

Although this project through which you map and capture your personal journey and discoveries is primarily centred on your personal journal (the detail of journaling and reflection is dealt with extensively in session 1 and throughout the programme), a number of other activities have also been included through which mastery of this challenge is monitored and measured.

An excerpt of the tools included in your learning material is included, but other activities also make up this part of your portfolio and are listed below.

- **Your first journal entry which includes describing yourself**: This is a free choice item but we recommend that you include it to refer back to over the duration of the programme.
- **Learning through reflection:** Consider the following statements and answer them honestly in your journal: Write a statement describing your best self, write a life statement that defines who you are and where you are going, write down how you think people see you. Now, write down how you see yourself.
- **Leadership inventory and conclusions drawn from it**: It is essential that you capture your reflections on your inventory. Copy these as well as your conclusions in respect of those positive aspects to further build on as well as the areas to develop in your journal or separately. Please do not include your original leadership inventory document in your final portfolio! Keep it to refer back to after the programme.
- **Emotional intelligence**: Capture what you have learnt and plan to actively undertake.
- **Six leadership style radar chart and development needs**: You are expected to include the radar chart but more importantly what you have learnt from the measure and what challenges lie ahead for you.
- **Transforming myself as follower**: Complete the document and include a copy of it as well as the actions you plan to take in your portfolio.
- **Sources of power**: Indicate how you will capitalise and further build on your positive sources of power and how you will develop your weak source of power and reduce the negative impact.

- **Identity:** Complete your identity framework, then indicate how you will live this identity authentically both professionally and personally. What might negatively impact on this? Give one measure that you will put in place to ensure you stay true to your identity.
- **DISA:** Extract your strongest DISA behaviours and two actions you will take to strengthen these even further. Extract your weakest DISA behaviours you need to develop most and four actions you will take. After sharing preference with team, ask your team to provide feedback on improvements noticed and capture this feedback in your POE.
- **Your personal commitment to diversity,**
- **Letter to yourself as your own best friend:** Write it according to guidelines given on the slide.
- **Ikigai:** consider the scenario that suits you best and why. How could you make your reason for being more meaningful by working on your passion, profession, vocation and mission.
- **Ethics:** Once you have completed the ethical orientation questionnaire you need to reflect on it and capture your insights. What impact does your ethical approach have on the decision making in the team and on you as follower? Give examples of ethics of justice and ethics of care as you have experienced it in your team.
- **Essay on development as authentic leader:** Study the article 'Discovering Your Authentic Leadership'. Write an essay of no more than two pages using the eight questions on page 5 of the article. Write a concluding paragraph on your insights thus far on the programme and its value to you as a leader.
- **Transactional analysis:** capture the EGO states you typically use when engaging with the spread of followers indicated and then indicate how you need to change your typical state to be able to engage in an adult state.
- **Communication:** which three tips will you be applying to improve your verbal communication? Once you have implemented it ask your team for feedback on it and then capture one such incidence.
- **Change:** Observe change in your personal and work environment and identify the type of change you are experiencing, identify your initial

response/concerns/emotions and be aware of where you get stuck on the cycle and why. Capture at least one such an incident.

1. LEARNING THROUGH REFLECTION (THEME 1)

1.1 Consider the following statements and answer them honestly in your journal:

Write a statement describing your best self.

My best self is confident, self-assured, and independent. She takes life, with all its ebbs and flows, not only as a challenge but as an opportunity to learn, grow, and ultimately blossom. She is fiercely protective of her space and energy but is also unafraid to be empathetic and vulnerable when needed. She is not afraid to do the hard things that will lead to improvement in her life- whatever that may be. She gets things done! She is humble enough to acknowledge when she needs help and courageous enough to reach outside to ask for help and guidance along her journey. She has a community around her that she draws from, as also she imparts her wisdom and experience.

Write a life statement that defines who you are and where you are going.

Right now, I am in a state of flux and stagnancy. I feel hamstrung by my lack of progress but also a deep fear and sense of failure. Despite feeling stagnant in certain areas of my life, I carry an unwavering desire to grow, evolve, and flourish. I embrace my journey, knowing that every step forward is a part of my becoming. I am resilient, full of potential, and committed to breaking through the barriers- both internal and external-that hold me back. I honour my past failures and shortcomings but refuse to be defined by them. I seek wisdom in my struggles and strength in my identity. My life is a canvas, and I will paint it with purpose, passion, courage, and progress.

Write down how you think people see you.

People likely see me as a driven and astute woman, especially because of my career as a Data Scientist, which suggests that I'm analytical and detail-oriented. As the first daughter of an immigrant family, I imagine many see me as responsible and dependable, often shouldering the weight of expectations. My introverted nature probably makes me appear quiet or reserved, and those who don't know me well might see me as someone who values solitude or prefers to stay in the background. However, those closer to me might

recognize that I'm thoughtful, introspective, deeply caring, and empathetic to the needs of those around me.

Write down how you see yourself. Transfer to your POE.

I recognize that I often feel trapped by fear and resigned to a life that doesn't fully reflect my choices. I tend to avoid the spotlight, concerned that my flaws will be exposed, but I'm also resolute not to let the fear of not reaching my potential hold me back. The weight of past failures does not define me; it fuels my determination to prove my worth and embrace my successes. This internal tension-between my desire for more and my self-doubt- drives me to confront what isolates me and pushes me to become the person I aspire to be. I am committed to breaking free from this fear and stepping into my full potential.

2. LEADERSHIP INVENTORY REFLECTION AND AREAS TO BUILD ON/DEVELOP (THEME 4)

2.1 Leadership inventory reflection

- Interpretation and Journaling: I often perceive myself as more mediocre than others do. I tend to be much more critical of myself, mainly due to my past failures and disappointments. My leader and team likely have a more objective view of my work and impact than I do. This realization has helped me maintain a more objective and dare I say, optimistic, perspective when assessing myself and has also alleviated some of my imposter syndrome.
- Patterns in relative assessments
  - Me vs. My Leader: My leader considers me to be technically competent. His assessment scores were consistently higher than my self-assessment, especially in the areas **of Intelligence and Results-Centeredness**. I consistently deliver high-quality work, although I recognize that there is room for growth in taking on more leadership and mentorship roles within the team.
  - Me vs. My Peers: My peers view me as a highly competent and valuable contributor. Their feedback has been overwhelmingly positive, particularly regarding my intelligence, ability to follow instructions, and delivery. They

appreciate that I can clearly articulate ideas and communicate effectively with stakeholders while also holding them accountable to the team.

- Overall: The sentiment from both my leader and peers is largely positive. While there is definitely room for growth- particularly in becoming more visible and sociable within the team—my team is very satisfied with my work.

- Five or so areas that are clear strengths that I should build on.

1. My professionalism and high-quality work output- I need to strengthen my technical knowledge and capability. Develop a niche strength for which I am the go-to person.

2. I actively listen and execute instructions from my manager and team efficiently, demonstrating strong followership. I understand the broader vision of our team's goals and can be relied on to support my colleagues in achieving them. Whether it's providing guidance, technical assistance, or just being a sounding board. To build on this strength, I can focus on mentorship or coaching, helping others grow while further establishing myself as a leader in the team.

3. My team trusts me to provide honest, constructive feedback regarding the progress and challenges of my work. This transparency builds a culture of trust within the team and ensures that issues surface early, allowing for timely intervention. I also ensure that I maintain open communication with key stakeholders. To build on this, I can strengthen my influence by offering proactive solutions, suggesting process improvements, and becoming more vocal in cross-functional discussions, adding value not just within my team but across departments.

4. I thrive in a collaborative environment, balancing teamwork with a strong sense of accountability for my individual contributions. I ensure that my work aligns with team goals while taking ownership of the quality and timeliness of my deliverables. Moving forward, I can amplify this strength by stepping into

more leadership roles within team projects, where I can guide the team while maintaining a high standard for my own output.

5. I have developed the ability to articulate key objectives clearly and succinctly to team members and stakeholders, ensuring alignment across the board. Whether presenting data insights or discussing project progress, I tailor my communication to suit the audience, making information both comprehensive and accessible. I aim to refine this strength by enhancing my influencing skills and learning how to better persuade and align stakeholders at all levels with the strategic vision of the team and organization.

- Five or so areas that require serious development.

.1.1 **Increase visibility as a capable leader and expand my influence**- Although I contribute significantly to my team, I'm well aware that I need to be more proactive in showcasing my leadership abilities, within my team and across the organization. I can take on more high-visibility projects and actively volunteer to lead initiatives, even outside my core responsibilities. Engaging in cross-functional projects or leading internal innovation could provide opportunities to demonstrate and hone my leadership skills.

.1.2 **Building and Strengthening Networks Within the Organization** – I need to have a strong network within the organization to grow and expand in my career, as it can open up opportunities for collaboration, learning, and visibility. I need to deliberately expand my professional network by attending internal events, data science working groups, and increasing my exposure to other data science teams.

.1.3 **Demonstrating Greater Passion and Enthusiasm for My Work** – There is room for me to convey genuine enthusiasm and curiosity about my work. Passion is contagious, and showing a higher level of engagement can inspire others and elevate my performance. I can show greater initiative by proposing innovative ideas and suggesting process improvements. Additionally, I should seek opportunities to challenge

myself by pushing the boundaries of my role- whether by taking on more complex projects or acquiring new skills such as furthering my studies.

.1.4 **Challenge Myself to Take on More Responsibility**- Although I am dependable in delivering results, I need to go beyond my current responsibilities and step outside my comfort zone. I can actively seek out stretch assignments or leadership roles within team projects that test my limits and push me to grow. I will also volunteer for assignments that involve managing more resources, handling stakeholder relationships, or leading presentations to senior stakeholders.

.1.5 **Taking Ownership of My Own Development and Career Progression**- Relying solely on external guidance or opportunities for growth limits my career potential. I need to proactively shape my career path by setting clear goals and taking the necessary steps to achieve them. My first priority regarding this is acquiring my Master's degree in Data Science.

- What surprised me

  My self-assessment scores were consistently lower than those given by my peers and managers, which reflects a pattern I've noticed in how I perceive myself. I tend to view my abilities through a more critical lens, often comparing myself to an idealized version of who I think I should be, shaped by past failures and disappointments. This creates a disconnect between how I view my contributions and how others experience them, leading me to undervalue my achievements and skills. As a result, I recognize the need to recalibrate my self-perception to align more with the reality of my capabilities and the value I bring to my team.

- How this made me feel

  I mostly feel relieved—I'm not as awful as I think. There is always room for growth, and I am open to it. This realization has made me understand the importance of maintaining balance in my life, acknowledging both the good and the bad. It's okay to recognize and celebrate my

successes and strengths. I need to see myself in the same way my peers view my strengths.

2. LEADERSHIP INVENTORY REFLECTION AND AREAS TO BUILD ON/DEVELOP (THEME 4)

2.2 Personal development plan, signed by leader

- Clear strengths on which I will capitalize and specific actions I will take:
    a. Capitalize on my great communication and presentation skills to reach a wider audience and network.
    b. Delivering high-quality work that is valuable to stakeholders although I need to home in on quantifying the actual value of the work through continuous engagement even after the delivery of the work
- Development needs and actions, I will take. Timeline and Priorities.
    a. Lean into taking more leadership roles in my team, including peer mentorship and making myself more visible to a wider audience in the organization via knowledge and expertise-sharing sessions: **FY Q1**
    - Sharpen my technical acumen by deepening my knowledge (Gen AI, AWS)- mostly it. Also sharpening my technical acumen by deepening my knowledge so I can find a niche for which I am the go-to person. Climb up the technical expertise level in Vodacom. – **Full Year of FY 2025**
    b. More sharing within the team- delegate and bring junior team members into the fold.: **On-going process which is in progress.**

Signed by : Pamela Afful Date: 25/11/2024

Verified by leader : Raphael Lenkwane Date: 25/11/2024

3. EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE (THEME 4)

3.1 Capture what you have learnt and plan to actively undertake

Insights

- I've come to realize that my emotions are far more nuanced, complex, and dynamic than I initially believed. Emotions aren't just binary (good or bad); they carry multiple layers and shades of meaning. Through personal reflection, I've discovered an entire reservoir of emotional depth within myself. Now, I have the language to identify and describe these emotions which allows me to navigate them with more clarity and awareness.

- I've learned that my emotions, whether positive or negative, are not something to dismiss or judge. They serve as a natural response to my internal landscape or external circumstances. Instead of labelling my emotions as "wrong" or invalid, I acknowledge their legitimacy. What truly matters, however, is how I respond to those emotions. Being conscious of my emotional responses enables me to grow as a leader who is more empathetic, emotionally intelligent, and capable of connecting with others on a deeper level. The right response helps build a more compassionate environment.

Actions I aim to take

- I aim to consistently use tools like the emotion wheel to dig deeper into the emotions I experience. Instead of stopping at surface-level feelings, I intend to explore the root causes and triggers that lead to emotional reactions. This conscious investigation will help me move beyond simply experiencing emotions and toward understanding them, allowing me to react thoughtfully rather than impulsively. Whether I feel overwhelmed, frustrated, or elated, my goal is to sit with these emotions and dissect them to gain greater self-awareness.
- I aim to engage in more self-reflection, allowing myself to fully experience my emotions rather than suppressing them. I want to break the habit of dismissing my feelings just to keep the peace or avoid confrontation. This will allow me to build a stronger emotional foundation

and make more authentic decisions. This will also involve resisting the urge to prioritize people-pleasing at the cost of my emotional well-being and learning to embrace the uncomfortable moments to foster personal growth.

3.2 Give feedback on one instance where you implemented eq and what feedback you received

During the psychological safety project, I demonstrated emotional intelligence while assembling a syndicate group. The team was under significant pressure from ongoing projects and daily commitments, so I approached them with care to avoid adding unnecessary stress. Initially, there was some hesitation about participating in a project that did not directly impact their individual roles.

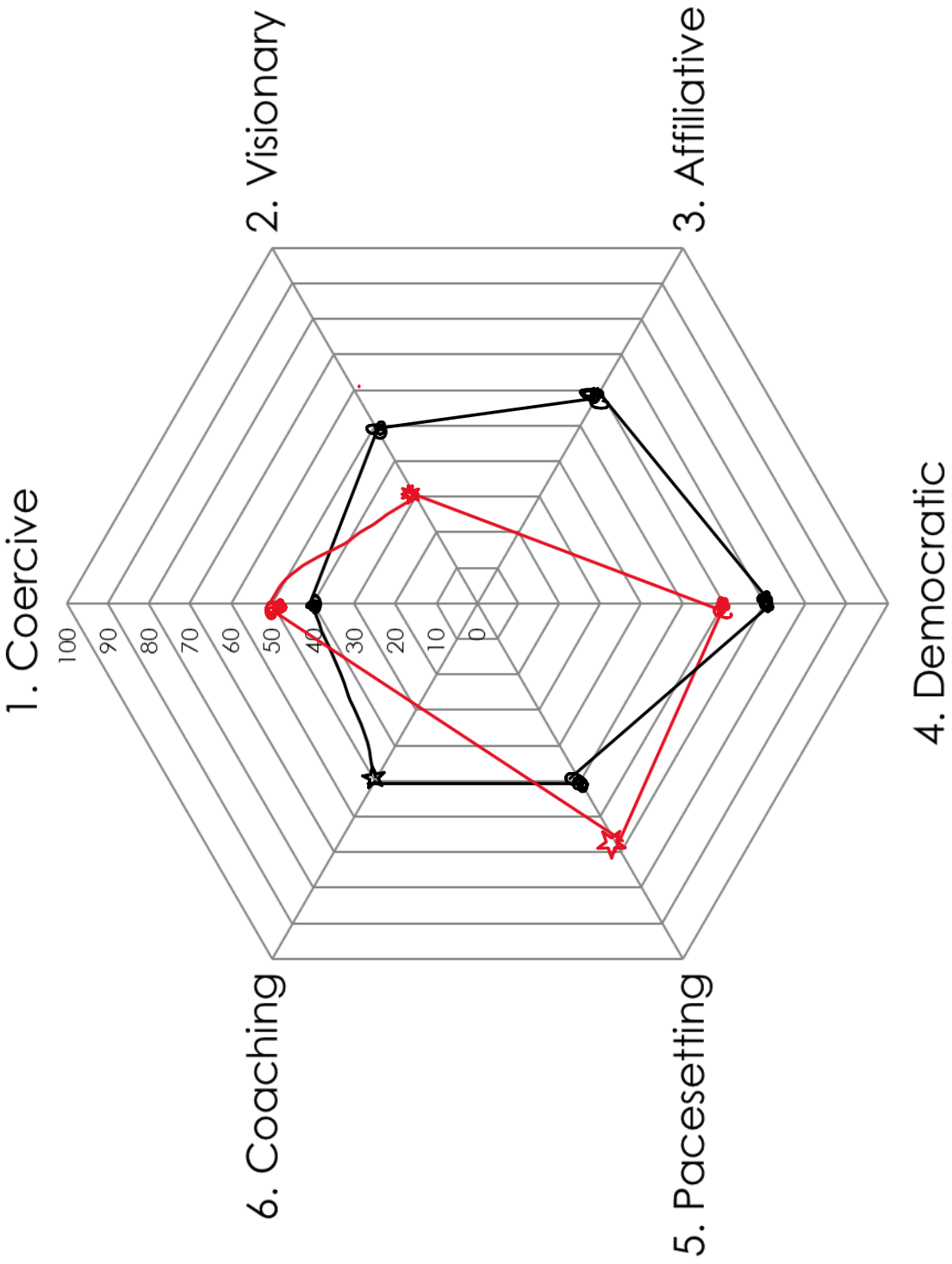
To address this, I reframed the project as a potential net benefit for the team, highlighting how it could improve collaboration and tackle shared challenges. I was mindful of their workloads and ensured the project was structured to minimize additional strain. By presenting a clear plan and streamlining meetings, I sought to make participation as seamless as possible.

When team members missed scheduled sessions without prior notice, I practiced patience and flexibility, understanding the demands on their time. I addressed the situation by proposing clearer communication protocols for scheduling conflicts and offering alternative options, such as intermediate updates, to accommodate their availability. Throughout, I balanced **adaptability** and **empathy** with **assertiveness** to maintain progress.

The feedback from my team was positive. They appreciated my leadership style, noting that I made the process simple and effective while respecting their boundaries and commitments.

4. SIX LEADERSHIP STYLE RADAR CHART AND DEVELOPMENT NEEDS (THEME 4)

4.1 Radar chart



4. SIX LEADERSHIP STYLE RADAR CHART AND DEVELOPMENT NEEDS (THEME 4)

4.2 Reflections on six leadership styles – areas for nurturing, development and mediation

- The leadership style that most aligns with my values and approach is the **Democratic Leadership Style**. I thrive on collaboration and believe that the inclusion of diverse perspectives enhances decision-making and problem-solving. This style resonates with me because I genuinely enjoy hearing and incorporating different viewpoints, creating an environment where each person's voice feels heard and respected. I believe that by recognizing and harnessing the unique strengths and talents of each individual, we can achieve better outcomes. The collective effort has the potential to yield results that are far better than what any one person could achieve alone. For me, leadership is not about control or authority but about nurturing and empowering others towards a sense of shared responsibility.
- I would like to strengthen more competencies in the **Coaching** and **Visionary** leadership styles. I would like to be able to identify and foster the strengths and capabilities of the people around me. I also want to nurture the ability to inspire people towards a common objective.
- However, I recognize a potential disadvantage in being too accommodating of every opinion in the decision-making process. While democratic leadership thrives on collaboration, it can sometimes lead to delays, diluted decisions, or compromised quality if every viewpoint is given equal weight, regardless of merit. I must be careful not to sacrifice high-quality work and performance in my attempt to reach a consensus. To counterbalance this, I see the value in selectively incorporating qualities of **Autocratic Leadership** when necessary. At times, making decisive choices, setting clear boundaries, and maintaining high standards may require a more directive approach.
- A recent instance where I had to mindfully adjust my leadership style occurred during a project that felt stagnant due to my attempt to consider various opinions in the interest of being a democratic leader. I realized I needed to practice assertiveness by weighing the value of accommodating different opinions against the necessity of getting

things done. Consequently, I altered my natural leadership style to adopt a more autocratic approach, prioritizing the needs of the project above all else. This allowed me to address the most pertinent issues (where I ultimately had the final say) while successfully delivering the project within a reasonable timeframe.

Changes in personal life:

- One of the key changes I need to make in my personal life is to become more assertive in asking for and getting what I want. Too often, I've found myself sacrificing my own needs and desires to avoid conflict or maintain peace. This pattern of people-pleasing, while comfortable in the short term, has led to frustration and a sense of losing touch with my authentic self. Going forward, I need to prioritize my own well-being and recognize that my needs are just as valid as anyone else's. This means becoming more comfortable with direct communication, clearly expressing my desires, and setting boundaries when necessary. Assertiveness doesn't mean being aggressive, but rather, standing up for myself in a way that is both respectful and confident. By doing this, I can foster healthier relationships where my needs are recognized and valued.

Changes in potential leadership style:

- I need to embrace authenticity and accessibility when offering my perspective to others within my network. As someone who tends to lead with democratic style, my natural inclination is to create an inclusive environment where everyone feels valued. However, being truly authentic in my leadership also requires me to be more open and forthcoming with my own insights, opinions, and expertise. I sometimes hold back from sharing my views, especially in group settings, to avoid dominating the conversation or causing friction. Moving forward, I'll need to trust that my perspective is valuable and can help guide decisions and problem-solving efforts. By being more transparent and confident in expressing my thoughts, I can foster a culture of openness where others feel empowered to do the same.
- Another crucial shift in my leadership style will be to take a more active interest in the work of my colleagues. I need to be more intentional

about checking in with others to understand their projects, challenges, and successes. I'll aim to seek out opportunities to engage with them: whether by offering feedback, asking questions, or simply showing curiosity, these interactions will work to build stronger relationships and reinforce my potential leadership presence. It also enables me to identify areas where my colleagues may need support, guidance, or encouragement, enabling me to step into a coaching role more effectively.

5. TRANSFORMING MYSELF AS FOLLOWER (THEME 5)

5.1 Self-assessment on own ability as follower

Assess yourself as you behave most of the time using the scale provided. Be honest with yourself as this assessment is aimed at identifying those followership qualities and behaviours that you should build on, and those that you should aim to develop further. The results of this assessment are further intended to help you in developing your relationship with your leader.

0 - Not at all	1 - Hardly	2 - Sometimes	3 - Mostly

1	I am not dependent on my leader to solve problems and make decisions	2
2	I admit my mistakes	3
3	I always exhibit loyalty to the team that I am a member or leader of	3
4	I am always willing to challenge my leader's policies and behaviours particularly when I experience it to be harmful to our common purpose or hurtful to others	2
5	I am an independent and critical thinker; my knowledge and judgement can be trusted	3
6	I am committed to the organisation as well as to a purpose or cause beyond myself and my own needs	1
7	I am good at working in teams in pursuit of organisational goals	3
8	I am known for my enthusiasm in pursuing our goals	2
9	I am known to be an energetic supporter of my leader's strategic agenda	2
10	I am not intimidated by hierarchy and organisational structure	2
11	I anticipate what personal competence and authority I need to be effective	2
12	I constantly build my own competence to be of better use to my organisation	2
13	I form my own views and ethical standards and stand up for what I believe in	2
14	I fully appreciate my leader's value	1
15	I give credit where credit is due and share successes	3
16	I have made an active, conscious decision to contribute towards the achievement of the goal of my organisation	2
17	I help my leader to stay on track by advising him/her in advance of pitfalls, problems and risks	2
18	I take on responsibilities wider than what is expected of me, but first do a superb job of my core responsibilities	3
19	I perform independently of performance management and control systems	2
20	I play a counselling and coaching role to my leader	1
21	I recognise the authority of my leader and the limitations it imposes on my own actions	3
22	I see myself, except in terms of line responsibility, as my leader's equal	1
23	I seek and encourage honest feedback from my leader	2
24	I speak my mind and hold myself accountable for the consequences of my actions	3
25	I take initiative and have a strong sense of responsibility	3
26	I truly believe that I, jointly with my leader, have a responsibility to accomplish a greater purpose	1
27	My leader can safely delegate responsibility to me	3
28	My leader views me as a 'self-managing' follower	3
29	My performance standards are higher than what are required	2

30	My relationship with my leader is candid, respectful, open and honest	3

SCORING:

Transfer your scores to the tables below and add the scores to indicate your effectiveness as a follower in the five dimensions/qualities of an effective follower:

SELF-MANAGEMENT	
Q 10	2
Q 11	2
Q 19	2
Q 22	1
Q 27	3
Q 28	3
Total out of 18	13

COMMITMENT	
Q 3	3
Q 6	1
Q 8	2
Q 16	2
Q 17	2
Q 26	1
Total out of 18	11

COMPETENCE AND FOCUS	
Q 1	2
Q 7	3
Q 12	2
Q 18	3
Q 25	3
Q 29	2
Total out of 18	15

COURAGE	
Q 2	3
Q 4	2
Q 5	3
Q 13	2
Q 15	3
Q 24	3
Total out of 18	16

LEADER-FOLLOWER RELATIONSHIP	
Q 9	2
Q 14	1
Q 20	1
Q 21	1
Q 23	2
Q 30	3
Total out of 18	10

TOTAL OF ALL DIMENSIONS:

INTERPRETATION:

1. Any score of 2 or below indicates a concern.
2. All scores of 3 indicates a positive element in the dimension concerned.
3. A total score of 13, 14 or 15 indicates a problem in that dimension and deserves attention.
4. Scores or 16 to 18 indicate health in a dimension.
5. All total scores of 12 and below indicate a <u>serious</u> problem in that dimension and demands urgent attention.

TOTAL SCORE:	**24**	**48**	**60**	**80**	**90**
	TOTALLY INEFFECTIVE FOLLOWER	INEFFECTIVE FOLLOWER	EFFECTIVE FOLLOWER	EXCEPTIONAL FOLLOWER	

5. TRANSFORMING MYSELF AS FOLLOWER (THEME 5)

5.2 Transform the leader-follower relationship by transforming myself (ANSWER ALL THE QUESTIONS; we numbered it for your convenience)

The heart of improving relationships is changing ourselves. This is where we have the most power to create change and the most reluctance to confront the need for it. The process starts with an honest examination of how we cope with authority relationships. Are we subservient, cynical and unwilling to take risks? Focusing on ourselves rather than on what is being done to us enables us to shift the balance. We need to examine our attitudes and behaviours to transform our relationships. Answer the following questions:

1. **What common purpose do I, the leader, and the group share?**

   Our common purpose is to create value for the business by improving our clients' experience with Vodacom's network. We achieve this by leveraging machine learning and advanced analytics to provide network engineers with data-driven insights to optimise network performance.

2. **Am I vigorously pursuing the common purpose and appropriately aligning and balancing my self-interests with my role?**

   No, I believe I could improve in this area. Although I complete the tasks assigned to me accurately, I struggle to feel fully invested in the team's or the organization's broader vision. I sometimes find it challenging to connect my role with the bigger picture and a sense of purpose.

3. **Does the common good require that I take more initiative to ensure that the group changes the way it works? Motivate your answer.**

   Yes and no. I know that my active participation is essential for making improvements but I still feel constrained by the organizational structures and bureaucracy that affect our work. My team and I often feel hindered by the unresponsiveness of our stakeholders, which impacts our project delivery and completion. The team can only do so much if leadership isn't open to changing their approach to work and the resources they provide us. Once again, the Product Owner Feedback Initiative is the first step to addressing my limited view of my impact.

4. **Will my behaviour in this relationship permit me to do that or do I need to risk new behaviours?**

   Not at the moment. Due to the geographical challenges I face (I work in a different city and office) and the constraints within the team, I feel restricted in my ability to influence change. New behaviours might be needed, but overcoming these barriers feels difficult right now.

5. **What is my power based on in this situation that would enable me to take greater initiative?**

   I could make a greater effort to ingratiate myself within the team making myself more visible as a source of knowledge to my leader and peers.

6. **What combination of knowledge, skills, reputation, networks and communication channels can I draw upon?**

   Currently, I feel restricted, both geographically and in terms of team dynamics, from leveraging my knowledge or networks effectively within Vodacom. The existing challenges create a sense of isolation and hinder my ability to draw on those resources. But I recognize I could put in more effort to reaching out to new people who are outside my immediate team's purview.

7. **Why am I hesitant to act?**

   The geographic distance from my team and the way our team makes it feel like any push for change would be futile. I'm hesitant because it seems as though there is little room to challenge or reshape the way things are done.

8. **Have I given up hope?**

   Yes, to some degree, though I haven't completely shut the door. There is still a part of me that believes change is possible, but it feels distant- literally and figuratively.

9. **Do I vaguely think that someone else will take the first step?**

   Yes, but I believe it will need to be a collective effort. The initiative on

psychological safety might be a good starting point for the team to engage more actively in improving our work environment.

10. **If action involves risk-taking, what is my personal source of courage?**

    Right now, I feel like I lack a strong source of courage. Without a clear sense of purpose or fulfillment in my role, it's difficult for me to feel empowered or motivated to take risks. Hypothetically, my source of courage would stem from the anticipated long-term improvement of the team, and I believe that the initial steps I take could snowball into a positive overall effect.

The greatest error we make is losing our respect for the human being who is in the leader role. In a deteriorated relationship with a leader, like a deteriorated marriage, we are so painfully aware of the other's shortcomings, that we lose sight of that person's strengths and value. To be effective change agents or partners we need to reconnect with what is right about the leader's behaviour. It is only from genuine respect that we can initiate change without being perceived as a threat. It is helpful to ask ourselves:

11. What skills and attributes enabled this individual to attain a leadership position?

    My leader has a demonstrated history of their ability to effectively guide and mentor junior team members, offering valuable insights and creating an open space for idea-sharing. His experience has served as a critical resource, both as a sounding board for new concepts and as a mentor. His previous projects have also had a tangible and measurable impact on Vodacom's revenue and customer impact both within Vodacom's domestic and international markets.

12. How were these adapted in the environment in which the leader developed and what respect do they deserve?

    The leader has been at Vodacom for a long time, starting from a graduate position to their current role as a principal data scientist. Their role has evolved in multiple capacities which has added to his skillset and competency. He also has the opportunity to work in different markets and contexts at

Vodacom which has further enhanced his development as a leader.

13. Are there ways, with some modification, in which these attributes can help accomplish the organisation's mission?

My leader can improve his mentoring and communication approach with our team and internal stakeholders to better align our efforts with the organization's mission. He should focus on fostering innovative thinking and identifying opportunities for cross-functional collaboration, which would enhance our team's visibility.

14. What pressures and challenges does the leader face?

They face the challenge of balancing internal team feedback with the often conflicting demands of external stakeholders. These stakeholders, who directly influence the team's funding and resources, expect results that may not always align with the team's day-to-day realities. Additionally, the leader contends with maintaining team morale while ensuring project deadlines and expectations are met. Navigating limited resources, managing team dynamics, and ensuring alignment with organizational goals all add layers of pressure.

15. Are those challenges pushing the leader to rely on old habits rather than risk new behaviours?

Yes, it is likely. Under pressure, leaders may revert to familiar methods to maintain control and achieve quick results, especially when faced with multiple competing demands. This reliance on established patterns can stifle creativity and hinder the exploration of more innovative and effective strategies in the long term. However, I do extend some grace to my leader, as he is quite new to our team and our way of working, which is more complex compared to other teams he has been a part of.

16. If the group gave the leader more or different support in dealing with those challenges would there be less reliance on the dysfunctional behaviours?

Yes, greater or more targeted support from the team could reduce the leader's reliance on outdated or less effective behaviours. We could work to

offer my leader constructive feedback and solutions to address external pressures. We could also start sharing responsibility for certain tasks or offering new approaches making him feel less burdened. It could also empower the leader to take risks, knowing they have a supportive, proactive team behind them.

17. How can I repair or strengthen the trust between myself and the leader so my concerns are given more weight?

I could initiate open, honest conversations where I express my concerns in a solution-oriented manner. I could offer more constructive feedback and show a willingness to collaborate on addressing key issues. This would signal that I am committed to the success of both my leader and the team.

18. What in the leader's self-interest can I appeal to that would make the leader more receptive to changes?

I can appeal to my leader's competitive nature and interest in team success and efficiency. I could position myself as a key player who can deliver value and enhance the team's visibility and effectiveness. I can demonstrate that supporting my ideas or feedback is in his best interest. I can do this by highlighting how positive changes can lead to improved team performance, recognition, and stakeholder satisfaction.

6. SOURCES OF POWER (THEME 6)

6.1 How do you capitalise and further build on your positive sources of power

- Information Resource: This has been my greatest source of power. As a data scientist, I analyze data and communicate insights to key stakeholders to help with forecasting, improvements, and strategic decision-making. My goal is to enhance my expertise and become the go-to person for a specific specialization within my team and the broader organization.
- History Power: I have a demonstrated history of producing high-quality and reproducible work. I need to continue in the same vein but work on showcasing this to a broader audience.

6.2 How do you develop your weak sources of power and reduce its negative impact

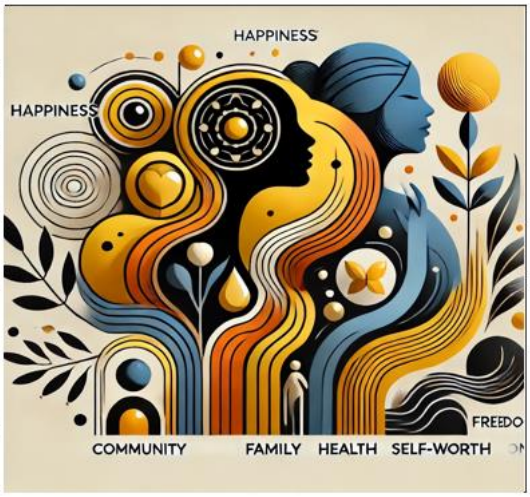
- Organisational Power: I need to network more and expand my zone of influence. I mostly work in a silo with very little need for direction or micromanagement. I need to reach outside myself and the immediate team to find my purpose in the larger scheme of things. Not addressing this will leave me stagnant and resentful.
- Resource Power: I want to have more influence in this area. Even though I do not possess tangible resources, I would like to take greater ownership of certain aspects that will help my immediate team work more efficiently.

7. IDENTITY (THEME 6)

7.1 Completed identity framework (my own) and logo

- **My purpose:** My purpose is to cultivate a life of joy, connection, and fulfillment, grounded in a strong sense of self-worth. By nurturing my health and well-being, fostering meaningful relationships within my community and family, and building lasting wealth, I strive to achieve a life of freedom and happiness that honours both my journey and the people who surround me.
- **My dream:** My dream is to live a fulfilled, complete life where I am a part of a strong, close-knit community.
- **My brand promise:** My brand promises to live life as authentically as possible, travel, and gain as many new experiences and perspectives. I aim to be a person of experience and culture.

My Dream		
My Purpose		My Brand Promise
	My Personal Identity	

My Core Life Values	My Personal Logo	My Core Operational Values
Happiness		Competence
Community		Honesty
Wealth		Knowledge
Family		Accountability
Health		Flexibility
Self-Worth		Fairness
Freedom		Tolerance

C2 General

7.2 Actions to take to ensure you authentically live your personal identity, professionally and personally

Happiness: I plan to regularly identify and engage in activities that bring me joy. I will invest time in hobbies that expand my interests. Additionally, I will practice gratitude by journaling the things I am thankful for. I will set boundaries to protect my time, peace, and energy for what matters most to me. I am done neglecting my feelings and compromising my values.

Community: I strive to build and maintain meaningful relationships through active listening, empathy, and vulnerability. This includes attending networking events to connect with like-minded individuals and support shared goals.

Wealth: I aim to set financial goals and develop a plan for saving, investing, and building assets. I have already started this process and will continue to explore ways to build long-term wealth. Additionally, I plan to seek financial education to enhance my understanding and ensure that my career supports my goal achievement.

Family: I will prioritize quality time with family, creating meaningful traditions and memories. I commit to communicating openly and honestly to nurture strong relationships.

Health: I will strive to maintain a balanced lifestyle through regular exercise, nutritious eating, and sufficient rest. I will schedule regular health check-ups to proactively monitor my well-being and practice mindfulness or meditation to alleviate stress and enhance mental clarity.

Self-Worth: I will make a greater effort to celebrate my achievements, no matter how small, to remind myself of my value. As an avid lifelong learner, I plan to invest in my personal and professional growth. I want to speak more kindly to myself, improve my thought patterns, and affirm my worth every day. I will strive to live according to my values and not base my self-worth on fleeting and changeable things, but instead on solid values that are foundational to who I am.

Freedom: I will declutter commitments or possessions that don't align with my values. I will pursue opportunities or experiences that provide me with autonomy over my time and decisions and work to ensure my career affords me financial freedom and flexibility.

7.3 Challenges that might negatively impact living your authentic identity

- My negative thought patterns- I tend to adopt a negative or more "realistic" view of circumstances putting an unreasonably large weight on the downside of making certain decisions.
- My lack of strong will- I often feel weighed down by my past shortcomings.
- Fear of being perceived or feeling good enough for good things to happen to be
- Self-sabotaging patterns in a futile attempt to shield my emotions from being disappointed.

7.4 One measure you will put in place to ensure you stay true to your personal identity

I will establish an accountability and reflection routine. I'll set aside time each month to reflect on how my actions align with my core values of happiness, community, wealth, family, health, self-worth, and freedom. During this time, I'll ask myself key questions like: did I stay true to my values? Where did I feel authentic, and where did I compromise? What adjustments can I make to live more in alignment with my purpose? I'll write down my thoughts, evaluate my progress, and identify one actionable step for the next week or month to reinforce my values—whether it's setting boundaries, nurturing relationships, or pursuing meaningful goals. By doing this, I'll remain grounded, intentional, and aligned with my true self and the version of myself that I am striving for.

8. DISA (THEME 7)

8.1 Extract your DISA behaviours and two actions you will take to strengthen these even further.

From DISC Website: "I am conscientious, diligent, and pay attention to detail. I constantly strive for accuracy and high standards with an inner drive to be systematic and precise in all I do."

Compliance (47%): I excel in Compliance, thriving in environments with clear rules, processes, and transparent frameworks. My conscientious and detail-oriented nature ensures that I uphold high standards and strive for precision. I value structure and consistency, but my preference for clarity means I can struggle in situations of ambiguity or vagueness.

Actions to take:

- **Develop greater comfort with ambiguity:** While I thrive within structure, I will challenge myself to adapt to situations where processes are not clearly defined. I'll practice creating clarity in ambiguous scenarios by proactively seeking context, asking key questions, and identifying priorities.

- **Balance precision with flexibility**: While maintaining high standards, I will work on being more adaptable when unexpected changes arise. I'll practice prioritizing tasks based on their impact rather than striving for perfection in every detail, ensuring efficiency without compromising results.

Steadiness (39%): I demonstrate strong steadiness through my calm, rational temperament. I approach situations with patience, thoughtfulness, and a logical mindset. This allows me to build trust and stability within teams, especially during high-pressure situations. The downside to this is that my preference for maintaining peace sometimes prevents me from addressing conflicts directly or taking immediate action when urgency is needed.

Actions to take:

- My calm nature is a strength, I will actively work on addressing conflicts or disagreements head-on by using constructive communication techniques. This will ensure my steadiness remains an asset even in challenging interpersonal dynamics.
- I will practice making quicker decisions when needed, especially in fast-paced environments. I will continue honing my ability to assess and act efficiently under pressure ensuring that I maintain rationality while adapting to urgent demands.

8.2 Extract your weakest DISA behaviours you need to develop most and four actions you will take.

Dominance (4%): One of my weakest DISA behaviours is dominance, which reflects my need to become more assertive and decisive. I often hesitate to express my opinions or take charge in situations that require firm decision-making. This limits my ability to lead effectively and advocate for my ideas.

Actions to take:

- Commit to speaking up in meetings and group discussions by preparing key points in advance and expressing my thoughts confidently.
- Work on saying "no" or negotiating when necessary, rather than defaulting to an agreement to avoid conflict.
- Volunteer for roles or tasks where I am responsible for making decisions and leading a team to build confidence in my judgment.
- Ask trusted colleagues or mentors for feedback on how I present myself in decision-making scenarios to identify areas for improvement.

Influence (17%): Another area for development is Influence, which involves expanding my visibility and network. I sometimes shy away from sharing them broadly or positioning myself as a thought leader. This impedes my opportunities to grow professionally and make a larger impact. This is especially challenging since I work remotely from my larger team.

Actions to take:

- Actively network within and outside my organization, attending industry events or joining professional groups to connect with influential individuals.
- Share insights, projects, and achievements on platforms like LinkedIn to enhance my visibility and establish credibility in my field.
- Volunteer to present ideas, lead workshops, or participate in panel discussions to increase my exposure and influence. One such platform is our department knowledge-sharing sessions.
- Partner with mentors and sponsors who can advocate for me in spaces where I may not yet have visibility, while guiding my journey to expand my influence. This has helped me tremendously in previous roles.

8.3 After sharing preference with team, ask your team to provide feedback on improvements noticed and capture this:

Team Feedback

- Influence: My team has advised me that I can enhance my visibility by utilizing the platforms available within the Big Data team to showcase and present my work. I have committed to presenting the results of my current project by the end of the first quarter of 2025.

- Dominance: I committed to becoming more vocal and assertive when advocating for and negotiating the work assigned to us by our Product Owners. The Psychological Safety Initiative we developed aims to make this process easier. The team has affirmed the value of this initiative

9. MY PERSONAL COMMITMENT TO DIVERSITY (THEME 7)

Diversity today is of utmost importance and is critical to building effective and productive teams. It is fundamental to driving innovation, fostering creativity, and driving all-round organizational change. I am committed to fostering an environment where people feel valued, respected, and empowered to bring their whole, authentic selves to the table.

I pledge to champion the personal identity, authenticity, and unique contributions of the team members I work with and eventually lead. This commitment extends beyond recognizing visible differences to embracing the richness of diverse perspectives, lived experiences, and cultural backgrounds in areas such as expertise, education, race, ethnicity, gender identity, sexual orientation, and ability.

To uphold this commitment, I will:

Educate Myself Continuously: I understand that unconscious biases can subtly affect interactions. I will actively seek opportunities to educate myself about these biases and challenge them, promoting self-awareness and personal growth.

Create Inclusive Spaces: I will actively contribute to fostering a culture of openness and belonging, where everyone feels heard and valued. This involves encouraging dialogue and seeking input from all individuals.

Embrace the Learning Process: Diversity is not just a superficial goal to reach- it's an ongoing journey. I will be patient with myself and others, recognizing that growth requires humility, persistence, and a willingness to listen and adapt. I will change my attitude toward diversity training as not just a checklist exercise but as an opportunity to deepen my understanding of inclusivity and my role in advancing it. By treating others with dignity, empathy, and fairness- the essence of the Golden Rule- I will strive to foster trust and collaboration across differences.

I am dedicated to actively participating in the creation of a culture that not only acknowledges diversity but also celebrates it. My goal is to foster an environment where inclusivity is instinctive. By embracing this commitment, I hope to contribute to a Vodacom that flourishes through the strength of its diverse workforce.

9. LETTER TO MYSELF AS MY OWN BEST FRIEND (THEME 8)

Dear Pamela,

Girl, give yourself a break! You're being way too hard on yourself for what you haven't accomplished instead of celebrating all that you have. Take a moment to recognize how far you have come. You're always striving for perfection or an idea of where you think you should be making it hard to see the forest for the trees. You've faced challenges, overcome obstacles, and grown so much- why not give yourself the credit you deserve? Let me remind you: you are doing the best you can with what you have, and there is still so much life ahead of you. That alone is a reason to feel excited, proud, and grateful.

Of course, there's always room for improvement; that is the essence of being human! But here's the thing: given how far you've already come, I have no doubt you'll achieve even more. It's all about progress, not perfection. Life has a funny way of unfolding exactly when and how it's supposed to, even if it doesn't match your timeline or expectations. Don't let past mistakes or disappointments make you question your worth. Rejection is just part of the process, it is a step on the journey, not the destination. It does not constitute the total of who you are. Please, have a little more faith in yourself- you are more resilient and capable than you realize. Even on the days you don't feel it, keep showing up for yourself. Pretend if you have to! Confidence is often born from the simple act of trying.

Put yourself out there! Don't let fear of failure hold you back. I know it feels safer to play small, but remember this: every failure is a lesson, and every success is proof of what you're capable of. Yes, you may fail, but you could also succeed! Have you ever considered that? Stop being so negative and pessimistic. Take a chance; you might just surprise yourself.

And let's talk about this "I'm just a realist" narrative you've been leaning on. That's not realism- it's a shield you're using to protect yourself from disappointment. I get it; vulnerability is scary. But by hiding behind that shield, you're also blocking out opportunities to grow, learn, and create the life you truly want. You're not a bystander- you're the CEO of your life, and it's time to step into that role with confidence and authority.

It's also important to remember that life isn't always in our control, no matter how hard we try. Things will happen that you didn't plan for or don't understand, and that's okay. C'est la vie, as the French say. These hard moments are just seasons, and like all seasons, they will pass. The sun always rises again. So don't let temporary difficulties steal your hope. Happiness isn't a constant state; it's something you have to fight for, nurture, and protect. And when you're struggling, don't be afraid to reach out for help. You don't have to carry the weight of the world on your own. Finding your people takes time, but once you do, the connections you build will uplift your spirit in ways you never thought possible.

Above all, remember this: life is meant to be lived, so LIVE IT! Every moment, every opportunity, every little joy- it's all worth embracing. So go out there, take risks, love fiercely, fail boldly, and dream bigger. You've got this, and I'll always be here cheering you on every step of the way.

With all my love,

Your Best Friend

10. IKIGAI (THEME 8)

10.1 Consider which one or more of the four scenarios best describes your current existence, and why this is the case.

- **Passion:** I enjoy helping young women in similar positions as I grow professionally as well as using data to solve problems. I enjoy analyzing trends, making informed decisions, and leveraging technology to create an impact.

- **Mission:** My mission is to be the best version of myself for both myself and others. I aim to ensure that more women who look like me are represented in my field. I strive to bridge the gap between data science and career empowerment, whether by mentoring others, advocating for diversity in tech, or using data to support underrepresented communities.

- **Vocation:** My analytical skills, strategic mindset, and interest in professional development align well with roles in data storytelling, business intelligence, machine learning, and career coaching in tech.

- **Profession**: I currently work as a data scientist, where I am paid to analyze trends using data, create valuable models that provide key business insights, generate revenue, and drive strategic organizational outcomes.

10.2 Consider the four areas of passion, profession, vocation and mission and what you could do in or all of these areas to make your 'reason for being' more meaningful.

- **Passion:** Right now, I'm not entirely sure what my passion is. I often feel like I do things just for the sake of doing them rather than out of a deep,

fervent desire. I recognize that passion can be cultivated through curiosity and experience. I want to explore what excites me within data science, mentorship, and professional growth so I can develop a stronger sense of purpose.

- **Mission:** My mission is to become the best version of myself while also uplifting others. Instead of seeking validation through people-pleasing, I will prioritize my own growth and fulfilment first- allowing others to benefit from the overflow of my efforts. Achieving this means putting in the work: building self-discipline, embracing discomfort, and continuously pushing myself toward excellence.

- **Vocation**- My skills and expertise lie in data analysis, reporting, and modelling. I want to deepen my technical knowledge, refine my analytical thinking, and leverage data-driven insights to solve real-world problems. At the same time, I aspire to use these skills beyond the workplace- potentially in mentorship, community impact, or entrepreneurship.

- **Profession:** I am a data scientist, and I am committed to growing in my career. This means overcoming my fear and imposter syndrome by actively putting myself in spaces where I can learn, contribute, and lead. I will make a deliberate effort to network, form meaningful connections, and seek out mentors and sponsors who can help propel me forward. Additionally, I will take on side projects that align with my passion for supporting young women who want to break into data science, ensuring that my success extends beyond myself.

12. ETHICS (THEME 9)

12.1 Ethical orientation questionnaire

Please answer the following questions by making a tick next to the correct one.

1. Which is worse?

hurting someone's feelings by telling the truth /

telling a lie and protecting their feelings

2. Which is the worst mistake?
   to make exceptions too freely
   to apply rules too rigidly
3. Which is worse to be?
   unmerciful
   unfair
4. Which is worse?
   stealing something valuable from someone for no good reason
   breaking a promise to a friend for no good reason
5. Which is better to be?
   just and fair
   sympathetic and feeling
6. Which is worse?
   not helping someone in trouble
   being unfair to someone by playing favourites
7. In making a decision you rely more on
   hard facts
   personal feelings and intuition
8. Your boss orders you to do something that will hurt someone. If you carry out the order, have you actually done anything wrong?
   yes
   no
9. Which is more important in determining if an action is right or wrong?
   whether anyone actually gets hurt
   whether a rule, law, command or moral principle is broken

Two Ethical Styles

The scores on your questionnaire show how strongly you prefer one or another of two major styles for recognizing and resolving ethical dilemmas. The higher your "J" score, the more you rely on an "ethic of j**ustice**." The higher your "C" score, the more you prefer an "ethic of **care**." (To see how each question was scored, see the answer key on the next page.)

Neither style is better than the other, but they are different. They may initially seem opposed to one another because they differ so much on the surface, but they're actually complementary. In fact, as the scores on your questionnaire show, you probably already rely on each style to a greater of lesser degree. (Not that many people end up with scores of 9/0 or 0/9.) Moreover, **the more you can appreciate both approaches, the better you'll be able to resolve ethical dilemmas and understand and communicate with people who prefer the other style.**

Ethic of justice

An "ethic of justice or rights" is based on abstract, impersonal principles, like justice, fairness, equality or authority. People who prefer this style see ethical dilemmas as involving primarily a *conflict of rights* that can be solved by the impartial application of some *general principle*. The statue "Justice Blindfolded" captures this approach very well. People with this style tend to place a good deal of weight on moral principles, laws or policies, which they believe should be applied to all equally. They usually do not like making exceptions based on special circumstances, and they worry about "setting precedents."

The advantage of this approach is that it looks at a problem logically and impartially. People with this style try to be objective and fair, hoping to make a decision according to some standard that's "higher" than any specific individual's interests. The disadvantage of this approach is that people who rely on it might lose sight of the immediate interests of particular individuals. They may unintentionally ride roughshod over the people around them in favour of some abstract ideal or policy. Carried to an extreme, people who strongly prefer this style may tolerate human harm in the name of some principle. Others might think them as inflexible, cold and uncaring. Their approach can appear to be not simply impartial, but impersonal.

This style is more common of men than women, and of people who define themselves in more solitary, individualistic terms. It seems to fit with a more legalistic approach to life that gives allegiance to some external source of authority. This approach can also go along with a traditional management

style that prefers to justify decisions according to authority, policies or other impersonal standards, like numbers or executive prerogative.

Ethic of care

An "ethic of care or responsibility" is founded on a sense of *responsibility* to reduce actual harm or suffering. For these people, moral dilemmas generally involve a conflict of duties or responsibilities. People with this orientation believe that the focal point of every ethical dilemma is the *specific individuals involved* and the *particular circumstances* of the case. Solutions, then, must be tailored to the special details of individual circumstances. Notions of equity, or what is *appropriate* or "fitting," tend to be favoured by this approach. Making exceptions does not phase these people, and they tend to feel constrained by policies that are supposed to be enforced without exception.

The advantage of this approach is that it is responsive to immediate suffering and harm. This approach is flexible, caring and subjective--appropriately so. It can respond quickly to changing circumstances and is not preoccupied with the idea of setting precedents. The bad news, however, is that by focusing so much on circumstances, people with this orientation can lose sight of the forest for the trees. Their reliance on subjective, "gut" response can limit their appreciation of other factors. When carried to an extreme, this style can produce decisions that seem not simply subjective, but arbitrary.

This style is more common of women than men, and of people who define themselves primarily in terms of their relationships with other people. It seems to fit with a more situational approach to life. This orientation seems related to a management style that is sensitive to the consequences of decisions on the individuals involved, that considers consensus-building to be very important, and that emphasizes having people do things as a result of personal "buy-in" rather than simply following orders.

ANSWER KEY:

1) HURTING FEELINGS (C)/ TELLING LIE (J)

2) MAKE EXCEPTIONS (J)/ APPLY RULES (C)

3) UNMERCIFUL (C)/ UNFAIR (J)

4) STEALING (J)/ BREAKING PROMISE (C)

5) JUST (J)/ SYMPATHETIC (C)

6) NOT HELPING (C)/ PLAYING FAVOURITES (J)

7) FACTS (J)/ FEELINGS (C)

8) YES (C)/ NO (J)

9) HURT (C)/ RULE (J)

MY ETHICAL ORIENTATION: JUSTICE___6_____ CARE__3_____

http://www.ethicsandbusiness.org/stylequiz.htm

12.2 Reflect on your results and capture your insights.

- I have a strong justice-oriented ethical perspective, deeply valuing fairness, and equality, and advocating for these principles in my work and interactions. I prioritize logic and rationality when addressing situations and take a systematic approach to conflict resolution, often focusing on mitigating negative consequences and ensuring balanced outcomes. Structure and rules are important to me, as they provide a reliable framework within which I thrive and operate effectively.

- That said, I recognize the critical importance of empathy and treating others with humanity. While I value consistency, I also understand that people are not automatons; they are unique individuals with diverse needs, emotions, and circumstances. To lead effectively, I must balance my structured, logical approach with a genuine flexibility that allows me to adapt to the nuances of each person on my team. This will work to make me a more approachable and more compassionate leader and foster a healthier team dynamic.

12.3 What impact does your ethical approach have on decision making as a team leader?

- My ethical approach places significant weight on processes and frameworks, as they provide structure, reduce uncertainty, and give me a clear sense of direction. This allows me to approach decision-making in an organized and systematic way, ensuring consistency and fairness in my choices. This helps me navigate complex situations more effectively and resolve potential conflicts with clarity and focus.

- This approach has proven beneficial, particularly in maintaining objectivity and ensuring accountability within the team. However, I recognize that an overreliance on structure can sometimes create distance, and there is room for growth in building more authentic, personal relationships with my team members. Developing deeper connections and integrating empathy more intentionally into my decision-making will enable me to better understand individual needs,

fostering value within the team.

- My end goal is to balance my structured approach with adaptability and relational awareness, creating decisions that are fair, rational, human-cantered, and inclusive.

12.4 What impact does your ethical approach have on decision making as a follower?

- My ethical approach provides a solid foundation that guides my decision-making as a follower. It fosters a sense of safety by offering clear rules and processes that I can reference, ensuring consistency and fairness.

- With clear expectations, I understand my responsibilities and my position regarding them, which helps me navigate situations more effectively.

- Additionally, this approach has empowered me to make decisions with greater confidence and assertiveness. By aligning my choices with my ethical principles, I can act decisively while maintaining integrity and contributing meaningfully to my leader, team, and wider organisation.

12.5 Capture one incident of ethics of justice and one incident of ethics of care which you were part of in your team.

I work in the Network Engineering and Machine Learning Team at Vodacom, where I develop models to guide decisions about building and upgrading sites. A significant part of my role involves working with geospatial data, which often includes socio-economic features such as race, gender, and income levels.

- Ethics of Justice
  During the development of a model aimed at recommending areas for network upgrades, I discovered that certain socio-economic features in the data could unintentionally introduce biases. For instance, the model might prioritize regions with higher economic activity, which would

disproportionately benefit wealthier areas while overlooking underserved communities. To address this issue, I ensured that the data used in the model excluded features that could reinforce systemic inequities, such as race or income. Additionally, I advocated for an evaluation process that included fairness metrics to ensure the model's outcomes aligned with Vodacom's commitment to providing equitable service. This approach reflects the principles of justice by emphasizing fairness, impartiality, and the rights of all communities to access quality telecommunications infrastructure.

- Ethics of Care:
  On one occasion, I observed that a proposed model's recommendations would significantly impact rural communities, where connectivity is essential for education, healthcare, and economic opportunities. Although the data suggested prioritizing network upgrades in urban areas, I expressed concerns about the potential negative effects on rural residents. Working collaboratively with my team, we modified the model to incorporate qualitative insights from community feedback and stakeholders, ensuring that rural areas received proper attention. We ensured that we prioritized the well-being and needs of vulnerable populations, emphasizing empathy, and fostering a sense of responsibility toward those who depend on our services the most.

13. ESSAY ON DEVELOPMENT AS AN AUTHENTIC LEADER (THEME 9)

Which people and experiences in your early life had the greatest impact on you?

The people who have had the greatest impact on my life are my family and the mentors I've encountered throughout my career. My family has been a constant presence, influencing me through their love, challenges, and values—they have left an indelible mark (both good and bad) on who I am.

Professionally, I have been fortunate to meet colleagues and mentors who recognized my potential even when I did not. They have not only inspired my interest in data science but also guided me in discovering my own capabilities and

strengths. These relationships have fostered a love for learning, growth, and curiosity in me, leaving a lasting impression on both my personal and professional journey.

What tools do you use to become self-aware?

Self-awareness, for me, is an ongoing process. I have always been level-headed and rational, but I have come to realize the importance of stepping back to see the bigger picture—to "see the forest for the trees." This perspective is new to me, yet it has been transformative in how I process my emotions, decisions, and challenges.

I also do this quite literally by spending time in nature. Sitting quietly on a park bench surrounded by lush greenery or listening to the waves by the sea allows me to detach from overthinking and simply be. These moments of serenity remind me of the simplicity and beauty of life. It is in these spaces of deep reflection and calm that I can let go, feel deeply, and truly understand myself.

What are your most deeply held values?

Justice, fairness, kindness, and empathy are central to who I am. These values are deeply rooted in my Christian upbringing, which taught me to treat others with love, dignity, and respect. While my core values have not fundamentally changed since childhood, my understanding of them has deepened over time.

I have become more empathetic and open to the diverse experiences and challenges that shape people's lives, especially those that differ from my own. In addition to treating others justly, I have come to recognize the importance of expecting and advocating for fair treatment for myself—a realization I didn't always embrace. This growth has been empowering, as it reflects my commitment to aligning my actions with my values, both for myself and for others.

What motivates you extrinsically?

Financial wellness is a significant driver for me because it provides opportunities, privileges, and, most importantly, freedom. The ability to explore new activities, interests, and experiences without restriction is deeply fulfilling.

I'm also mindful of the balance between pursuing financial security and staying true to my values. I make a conscious effort to treat others with fairness and kindness, ensuring that my personal goals don't come at the expense of my integrity. Ultimately, I believe financial freedom should serve as a tool to live a purposeful life-

one where I contribute positively to the lives of others and maintain alignment with my eudaimonic aspirations.

What kind of support team do you have?

I have the support of my family. Although we do not always see eye to eye, I know they love me and genuinely want the best for me. They have encouraged me in my pursuits and consistently motivate me to improve. Their belief in my potential, even during times when I've doubted myself, has been a significant source of strength and inspiration.

Is your life integrated?

No, not yet. I compartmentalize my personality to best suit the situation at hand. This approach helps me maintain my sanity in circumstances that require a rational response.

However, I feel that a lack of progress in certain areas of my life, along with past experiences, has stifled my ability to fully express my authentic self. I do this as a means of self-preservation, although I am aware of the drawbacks it imposes on forming real, meaningful relationships.

What does being authentic mean in your life?

Authenticity, for me, is about living and leading in alignment with my core values. It's about integrity, sincerity, and staying true to who I am, even in the face of challenges. It means acknowledging my weaknesses while also celebrating and embracing my strengths.

Being authentic is also about evolution. It's a commitment to continuous learning, questioning my assumptions, and standing firm in what makes me unique. As an authentic leader, I aim to move through life with intention, consistently bringing my full self to every interaction and decision.

What steps can you take today, tomorrow, and over the next year to develop your authentic leadership?

- **Today**: Commit to small acts of bravery—speaking up, asking for feedback, or stepping outside my comfort zone in everyday situations. Start journaling regularly to reflect on my actions and ensure they align with my values.

- **Tomorrow**: Seek out new experiences that challenge me, whether through volunteering, collaborating with people from different backgrounds, or taking on leadership roles at work or in my community.
- **Over the next year**:
    - Pursue formal education or certifications to deepen my knowledge in areas that interest me, such as data science or leadership development.
    - Actively build my professional and personal network, by joining groups, attending events, or seeking mentorship opportunities.
    - Invest in my personal growth by dedicating time to hobbies and activities that bring me joy and fulfilment.

14. TRANSACTIONAL ANALYSIS (THEME 10)

14.1 Identify which ego state you typically engage in when interacting with: junior female followers, male senior leaders, women in leadership roles, your leader, followers in general.

- **Junior Female Followers**: I typically engage from an **adult ego state** when interacting with junior female followers. As a junior data scientist at the beginning of my career, I strive to build a collaborative and supportive relationship with them. I view them as peers on a similar journey and approach our interactions with both rationality and empathy. My goal is to treat them with respect and encouragement, demonstrating the professional conduct I would appreciate if I were in their position. This approach fosters a constructive and inclusive environment where mutual growth is prioritized.

- **Male Senior Leaders:** When I engage with male senior leaders, I often find myself in a **child ego state**. I perceive them as highly experienced, which makes me feel self-conscious and hesitant to assert myself in their presence. As a result, I sometimes downplay my contributions, fearing that I may come across as overly assertive, naïve, or unprepared.

- **Women in Leadership Roles:** When interacting with women in leadership, I often adopt a **child ego state**, accompanied by a sense of admiration and inspiration. I view these women as trailblazers who have likely faced significant challenges to reach their positions. I approach these interactions with enthusiasm and a strong desire to learn from them.
- **My Leader:** In my interactions with my leader, I operate from an **adult ego state**. I have developed a relationship that enables me to confidently express my ideas, insights, and concerns while remaining open to feedback and guidance. This balance fosters productive communication and mutual trust. I value the opportunity to learn from my leader while making meaningful contributions to our shared objectives, creating a dynamic that supports both personal and team growth.

- **Followers in General**: When interacting with followers, I maintain an **adult ego state**. As a junior professional, I view my peers and followers as equals who offer unique perspectives and skills. I aim to engage in a way that is fair, rational, and respectful, fostering an environment that encourages collaboration and shared learning.

14.2 How will you change your typical ego states above to engage in an adult state in future?

- **Male Leaders:** I'm working on shifting toward an **adult ego state**, recognizing that my input is valuable and that effective communication involves both confidence and humility. I believe this mindset will help me build more balanced and professional relationships with these leaders.

- **Female Leaders:** While I may initially feel a bit eager to impress or gain their mentorship, I aim to transition toward an adult state where I can establish genuine, professional connections that demonstrate mutual respect and collaboration.

15. COMMUNICATION (THEME 10)

15.1 Identify which two tips you will apply to improve your verbal communication.

- **Improve my body language and physical tone**

  Since I work in a virtual /remote setting, it is imperative that my audience can read my body language and facial expressions to reduce misinterpretations and hindrances to effective communication. As such, I will make it a priority to turn on my camera during virtual meetings. This will also work to enhance rapport building with my team and improve clarity and understanding. I will also make a conscious effort to maintain eye contact with the camera and use natural gestures to enhance my message. I will also ensure my lighting and background are professional and minimize distractions.

- **Limiting the use of technical jargon:**
  I will strive to use clear, concise, and accessible language, taking the time to explain technical terms in simple, everyday language. This is especially important when communicating my work to a non-technical audience. I will adapt my communication style to suit the specific audience and their level of technical expertise. I will actively seek feedback from my audience to ensure my communication is understood and appreciated. For example, during presentations, I will take time to ask the audience if they understand or if they have any questions.

15.2 Share this with your team and ask feedback from your team when they witness improved communication by you.

Overall, my team's feedback was largely positive. According to them, I am able to clearly and understandably communicate my work to the larger team. They can follow my logic and the flow of my work, especially around the technical details of my work.

The key improvement they highlighted was around improving the visibility especially since I work remotely from the team.

I have worked to improve this by turning on my camera when I have one-on-one meetings with my peers and manager. When I am speaking in a meeting where I have to give an update I deliberately turn on my camera. This works to improve

accessibility allowing my team to read my body language, feel my presence, and create a more comfortable environment for all.

My team has appreciated this extra effort in improving my communication resulting in increased engagement from my peers in meetings. I am also less distracted during meetings as my attention is a lot more attuned to the proceedings of the meeting when my camera is on.

16. CHANGE (THEME 14)

16.1 Observe change in your personal and work environment and identify the type of change you are experiencing, identify your initial response/ concerns/emotions and be aware of where you get stuck on the cycle and why. Capture at least one such an incident.

Key Change in the Work Environment:

Our team experienced a mix of **transitional and transformational** change in the form of a change in leadership, which temporarily disrupted team cohesion and harmony. Misaligned interests among stakeholders and communication gaps between leaders created friction, making it challenging to maintain alignment on priorities and execution.

Initial Response:

Initially (and to some extent, still) I felt frustrated, confused, and slightly anxious. The introduction of additional reporting and frequent (sometimes redundant) meetings disrupted my workflow, making it harder to focus on meaningful tasks. Some of these meetings felt counterproductive, further fuelling my frustration.

Concerns:

A major concern was the lack of a structured system to evaluate and communicate the impact of our work. Without clear metrics tying our contributions to business outcomes like revenue generation or cost savings, I worried that the new leadership might not fully grasp our value. This uncertainty made it difficult to feel confident about how our efforts would be perceived.

Emotions:

- Frustration – due to inefficiencies introduced by the change.
- Anxiety – about how our work would be evaluated under the new leadership.

- Mild resistance – towards certain processes that seemed unnecessary.
- Cautious optimism – as I recognized potential long-term benefits

Current Position in the Grief Cycle:

I believe I am transitioning from **bargaining to acceptance**. While I still find myself questioning some of the new processes, I am making a conscious effort to embrace the changes. I recognize that these adjustments are shaping the team's future dynamic, and I am working toward seeing their potential benefits rather than focusing solely on their disruptions.

PROJECT YOU: LEADING THROUGH COACHING

Zone of influence: leader of individual

The purpose of this project is to develop coaching skills by coaching a follower or another individual, to greater performance for the duration of the programme. This not only implies that you require knowledge of coaching, but also that you carefully select an individual whom you will coach. The first and very important task you have is to carefully select the 'coachee' according to the guidelines in your participant file.

This project spans months and requires detailed record keeping over this period. It is important that your 'coachee' understands the process that he/she is entering into, that you make time available to truly make a difference, that you agree on the way forward, what you aim to achieve and what gets recorded. This full record becomes the input into your portfolio of evidence and needs to be signed off by both of you. This record and process should amongst others include at least the following deliverables:

- What was the initial response of the coachee? What were your expectations in terms of this meeting, and were they met? Identify possible concerns that might negatively impact the relationship. Be aware of the impact of your own expectations. Capture at least ONE concern in your journal and transfer this to your POE.
- **Coaching agreement:** You are expected to conclude the written agreement with the individual. The coaching agreement is included in your POE file. Also study the guideline for the Project **YOU** report included in this file and share this with the individual you have chosen. This will give an understanding to both of you on the next two deliverables of this project and should inform your relationship agreement.
- **Project YOU progress report:** Using the guideline referred to above, you are expected to include a progress report on this project half way through the programme. In particular you should use the knowledge gained on your personality type as well as that of the 'coachee', to have a discussion with the individual and record the insights and the adjustments in behaviour that both of you intend making to accommodate each other's personality types. Capture this in detail in your progress report together with the review document.

- **Project <u>YOU</u> final report:** The final report should cover as a minimum the aspects contained in the guideline. As the core learning in this process is the giving and receiving of feedback and becoming comfortable in undertaking the required adjustment (from both sides) please also refer to reading related to emotional intelligence, listening skills, emotional control and feedback.

1. INITIAL RESPONSE (THEME 1)

What were your expectations in terms of this meeting, and were they met? Identify possible concerns that might negatively impact the relationship. Be aware of the impact of your own expectations. Capture at least one concern in your journal and transfer this to your poe.

Expectations and Initial Reflections

When I first considered mentoring a peer, I felt quite nervous. I'm not currently in a leadership role within my team, and I have no prior experience mentoring others, so this was completely new territory for me. However, despite my initial hesitation, I was eager to step outside my comfort zone. I saw this as an opportunity to test my abilities and begin developing the leadership skills I aspire to cultivate further.

My expectations were mixed. On one hand, I was skeptical and concerned that this might turn out to be a perfunctory task- a mere box to tick with little lasting impact. On the other hand, I was hopeful and curious about the potential benefits for both myself and my mentee. I aimed to approach the process with an open mind, recognizing that growth often comes from leaning into discomfort and embracing new challenges.

Key Concerns

1. Availability and Scheduling

One of my foremost concerns was logistical. Both of us have demanding schedules, so coordinating a mutually convenient time for our sessions was crucial. I worried that inconsistent availability could disrupt our progress and reduce the overall effectiveness of the mentorship.

2. Lack of Leadership Experience

Since I have never held a formal leadership position, I was unsure whether I could provide meaningful guidance. I feared that my mentee might expect more from me than I could deliver or that I wouldn't have the necessary experience to draw upon. At the same time, I recognized this as a learning opportunity for both of us—a chance to develop skills through collaboration and reflection.

3. Balancing Vulnerability and Professionalism

Another concern was finding the right balance in how I present myself. I wanted to be authentic, approachable, and relatable, but I also needed to project confidence and professionalism to foster trust and credibility in my role as a mentor.

2. COACHING AGREEMENT (THEME 1)

COACH: **Pamela Afful**

COACHEE: **Mmabatho Molebatsi**

We hereby voluntarily enter into a coaching relationship that we expect to benefit the coach, coachee, and the employer. We want this to be a productive and rewarding experience with most of our time spent in collaborative meetings. To minimize the possibility of confusion in our coaching relationship, we agree to the following:

- **Confidentiality undertakings**: Both parties confirmed that this is a strictly confidential arrangement and that all conversations and information shared during the coaching session will be kept strictly between the two parties.

Commencement date: **27 Sept 2024**

Concluding date: **31 Feb 2025**

Frequency and duration of meetings: On the last Friday of every month starting from the commencement date to the concluding date. Duration will span from 45 min to an hour.

Specific role of the coach (eg. agenda development, questioning, guidance, observing, feedback, recommending developmental activities, facilitated learning):

- **Showing up** and providing clear communication if any change arises.
- **Setting the agenda** and ensuring that the items that we discuss during the session tackle what the coachee wants to speak/engage on
- **Send follow-up or summary post-session emails** with links to resources and extra readings
- **Keep a record of my feelings** regarding how the session went.
- **Ensuring a non-judgemental** and safe space for both parties.

Specific responsibilities of the coachee (eg. agenda development, progress monitoring, reflection, journaling, keeping notes:

- Taking notes regarding how the session went from the coachee's perspective.
- Providing key points or themes that they want to talk about.
- Keeping a record of how the coachee felt at the end of the session
- Showing up- clear communication if any change arises.
- Monitoring progress against a set point plan that we have agreed to work through- ensuring that we are working through these points during the sessions.

Coaching objectives and any additional matters:

SIGNED: **Pamela Afful** (COACH) Date: **2024/09/12**

SIGNED: **Mmabatho Molebatsi** COACHEE) Date**: 2024/09/12**

3. PROGRESS REPORT (THEME 1)

Coach: Pamela Afful **Date: 2024-12-02**

Coachee: Mmabatho Molebatsi

Please indicate your agreement to the statements below using the scale indicated

D: Disagree

A: Agree

SA: Strongly Agree

	SD	D	A	SA
1. Frequent coaching sessions have taken place				X
2. Sufficient time has been devoted to the relationship				X
3. The relevant leadership/professional/behavioural development areas have been experienced				X
4. A clear coaching agenda with goals and objectives was agreed to				X
5. Trust and openness have been established				X
6. Confidentiality was observed				X
7. The coach displayed good listening skill				X
8. The coach demonstrated good questioning skill				X
9. The coach gave valuable feedback				X
10. The coachee monitored own progress throughout			X	
11. The coachee demonstrated skill in reflection				X
12. The barriers encountered in the relationship and process were effectively overcome				X
13. The development agenda for future development has been discussed				X
14. The coaching relationship met my expectations				X

SIGNED: _____ (COACH) Date: 02-12-2024

SIGNED: _____ (COACHEE) Date: 02-12-2024

4. FINAL REPORT (THEME 1)

5.

The report needs to contain the following:

1. Your name: **Pamela Afful**
2. Coachee name: **Mmabatho Molebatsi**
3. Coachee role/position: **Data Scientist**
4. Objectives of project:
   Below are the key themes our sessions fell under:
   1. The Power of being assertive and trusting your judgment.
   2. Navigating power dynamics when one starts to take leadership roles as a junior and maximising those opportunities.
   3. Incorporating personal passions into the workplace.
6. Main actions taken, overview of what happened over the past months
   - We compared and discussed the results of the DISA profile, exploring how to incorporate these insights into our daily work lives and future career aspirations.
   - We agreed on specific actions and goals for the coachee to integrate her personal interests into her professional life. We discussed the principles of Ikigai and how she can use this framework to align her interests with her work.
   - Additionally, we decided that the coachee should aim to expand her network and connect with a key individual at Vodacom who can provide valuable insights into her career plans.

7. Report by coachee

- My experience of the past months with my leader/mentor.

- *It has been interesting to open my mind up to areas of weakness/growth and to have engaging conversations that identify the realities of the workplace and how I exist in that but also still carry the ability to enact change. The coaching experience has reminded the value and importance of having career guidance, the conversations were always stimulating and offered insight.*

- What I have learnt in this period.

- *One of my main take-aways is that; taking action doesn't always have to be in dramatic measures. Step by step incremental efforts are better to know that rate of change and growth match and that I don't become too overwhelmed*

- My view on the extent to which the objectives have been met.

- *One of the objectives I had with the coaching was to learn how to be able to unpack the thoughts in my head about the way I feel in the workplace and learning how to have conversations about my current state and the desired state I want to reach. Gaining the tools to identify what is working but finding ways to develop in the areas I'm lacking in.*

- My ideas to my leader/coach on developing me into the future.

- *Our coaching was always a great conversation that leaned on openness and honesty which allowed me to speak about matters that I hadn't gotten the words yet to be able to talk to my managers about. The ideas and suggestions received helped to break down the issues to manageable sizes and also shared resources for me to expand in delve deeper.*

- Overall views on whether this experience was useful to me and successful.

- *The experience was very useful for me, I've had a coach before, and I wasn't sure if I still needed it but this experience has shown me that even though I've grown in the workplace the places I'd like to go I need support and guidance and in a coach I have found value.*

7. Conclusions (by leader/coach)

   I found the coaching journey to be purposeful, insightful, and overall fulfilling. I was able to be vulnerable and share my experiences with the coachee, which they found valuable. Although I was initially nervous, this journey ended up being a positive experience for both my coachee and me.

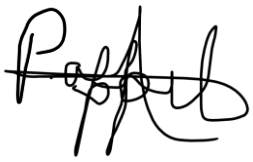
- What I have learnt from this project.

    - I learnt that there is a valuable lesson in every experience that can be parlayed into something greater.

- I learned I do not always have to have the answers but I should be open to researching and learning alongside my coachee.
- I learned to be resourceful and creative in the way I presented key insights and information to my coachee.

- My view on the success and value of this project to me as well as to my coachee.
  - This project has been a valuable and positive experience for both my coachee and myself. I believe its success lies in the mutual growth and self-discovery it fostered. We both gained significant self-awareness by identifying previously unexplored areas for personal and professional development. The coaching relationship created a safe space for vulnerability, allowing us to openly acknowledge our knowledge gaps without fear of judgment. This vulnerability, rather than being a weakness, became a catalyst for growth, enabling us to support and encourage each other in pursuing our respective goals.
  - Specifically, I observed increased engagement and interest from my coachee. Similarly, I benefited personally by honing my active listening skills, being more personable, and improving my research and organizational skills.

Signed and dated by both parties (VERY IMPORTANT)

9. SIGNED:  (COACH) Date: 31-01-2025

SIGNED:  (COACHEE) Date: 31-01-2025

PROJECT US: REPOSITIONING MYSELF WITH MY TEAM & CREATING PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY

Zone of influence: team leader

At the end of the programme you should not only have done some self-discovery, grown and developed as person but also as leader...and noticeably so. For you and the organisation to optimally benefit from your personal mastery and development, your team should be part of this journey, have the opportunity to learn from you and get the opportunity to give you feedback. This project is intended to guide and measure this process and re-position you as a more effective leader of your team. If you do not have a natural team that you lead i.e. you do not have people reporting directly to you, then you should use a group or team that you may be leading as a project manager or you should use the team that you are a member of. The following deliverables will indicate successful completion of this project:

- **Aspects of culture:** Identify the five most important elements that require change in your team to create psychological safety. Share this and agree to it, agree the actions and changes required by you as leader of this team, changes that should be made in the rest of your organisation to assist your team, Identify what you will pay special attention to in order to assist your team and the organisation to reach the desired state, psychological safety and live the organisation vision and purpose.
- **Individual psychological safety:** Leadership behaviours – write a short note on how you: Become a visible and present leader, become a brand ambassador (lived the brand), articulated the organisations visions to your team, lived the leadership behaviours, created Psychological Safety (refer 2.2 for your project inclusion).
- **Biases:** Refer to the Strategies contained in the articles "What works for women at work Maternal Wall Bias" and "What works for women at work Tightrope Bias" and identify strategies that you will employ, capture in your journal and POE the team advantages as well as your strategies.
- **Presentation to your own team and evaluations:** The crux of this project is your presentation to your team on your learning on the programme. With regards to this deliverable you need to include the following in your portfolio.
  - A hardcopy of the slides of your presentation.
  - All the evaluation forms completed by your team on your presentation.
  - Your reflection on how you have and plan to respond to the feedback received.

Remember that storytelling and the ability to persuade are key elements to distinguish you as leader. Be sure to include it in your presentation.

- **High-performance individual assessment:** After assessing your full team, identify patterns in attributes, dimensions and categories common to all low or all high performers. Present these patterns to your team and agree with them the actions that will be included in your team development plan. Include the plan in your POE.
- **Joint accountability:** Reflect on relationships, trust and candour within your team. Capture in your journal the actions that you will take as follows: My team leadership and team strengths that I will use more to improve on the above, My leadership and team deficiencies that I will share with my team and start doing something about.
- **Team effectiveness measure and development needs:** You will be assessing the effectiveness of the team that you are a member of to discover team effectiveness dimensions and how to develop a team development agenda. This is an exceptionally valuable tool and you should use it for your own team by asking your followers to complete it for your own team and then using it to develop your team.
- **Workstyles:** share your own workstyle and allow each team member to identify theirs. Capture the team profile and debate insights.
- **Team identity:** An exciting and very valuable activity to undertake is the Identity dream/vision, values, purpose, brand promise and logo) activity using the Identity framework as base document. Include both the identity activity outcomes as well as your reflection notes in your portfolio. You are encouraged to enrich the identity exercise meeting by also undertaking the personal values activity as it was done in the session with you. It is however not expected that you include anything in respect of the values exercise in your portfolio.
- **Strategy:** Assessment 3, include the final page (my priorities and actions) as well as your final self-assessment radar chart. Include the feedback you received from your team and how you will be responding to it.

1. ASPECTS OF CULTURE (THEME 2)

1.1 Identify the five most important elements that require change in your team to create psychological safety. Share this and agree to it.

- **Lack of Collaboration and Unified Goals:**
  Our current structure operates in silos, limiting collaboration and the sharing of ideas. This segmented approach prevents us from aligning on a shared objective, which diminishes overall team synergy and goal orientation.

- **Limited Autonomy and Overbearing Top-Down Influence:**
  Team members often feel constrained by decisions and expectations from higher management, including financial pressures. This sense of restriction raises fundamental questions about our purpose and role within Big Data.

- **Misaligned Responsibilities and Evaluation Metrics:**
  Many team members are performing tasks outside their primary specialization (e.g., data scientists taking on data engineering or ML engineering tasks). Furthermore, performance evaluations often do not accurately reflect the actual scope and nature of our work, creating a disconnect between our contributions and how we're assessed.

- **Misaligned Stakeholder Expectations:**
  There is a lack of clarity and alignment in the expectations of various stakeholders, leading to confusion and inefficiency as we try to meet divergent goals

- **Lack of External Recognition:**
  The team's efforts are not sufficiently acknowledged, with internal clients often receiving credit, which diminishes team visibility within the organization.

1.2 Agree the actions and changes required by you as leader of this team.

- Enhancing Visibility and Accessibility: Enhance my visibility within the team by switching on my camera during virtual meetings to create a sense of connection and approachability. Additionally, I will schedule regular check-ins with team members to encourage open dialogue and strengthen relationships.

- Driving Constructive Feedback Loops: Take the lead in organizing structured feedback sessions with stakeholders to identify actionable insights that help the team enhance its performance and the value it delivers. Create a transparent process to collect, analyze, and act on feedback, ensuring the team understands its impact and contributions. The Psychological Safety project is the first step to this.

- Collaborating Beyond Immediate Responsibilities: I will actively seek opportunities to support cross-functional initiatives and contribute my skills and insights to projects beyond my direct purview. This includes volunteering to participate in strategic planning or brainstorming sessions to add value within the team and across Vodacom.

- Sharing Knowledge and Promoting Growth: Regularly participate in knowledge-sharing sessions, presenting lessons learned, best practices, and innovative approaches from my work. Encourage team members to engage in similar sessions, fostering a culture of learning and collaboration. Document and share project outcomes, both successes and challenges, to build a repository of insights that the team can reference for future initiatives.

1.3 **Changes that should be made in the rest of your organisation to assist your team.**

- Ensure that initiatives are inclusive of employees who are located remotely relative to the head office. This works to ensure that all employees feel engaged and connected to the company.

- Empower teams to make independent decisions within predefined guardrails (e.g., budget constraints, strategic alignment). Our team would have greater ownership of decision-making within our domains, reducing constant top-down directives.

- Hold regular alignment meetings where product owners and the leadership of the Big Data team establish clear expectations regarding deliverables, priorities, and timelines. We communicate these expectations to the entire team and implement a process to hold product owners accountable for addressing potential roadblocks within their control to ameliorate (enhanced consequence management).

- Establish a project intake process to assess business needs before execution in order to prevent scope creep. This approach will reduce confusion, enhance efficiency, and ensure that priorities are aligned with business objectives. Additionally, we should implement an established process for reporting and evaluating how these needs are measured.

1.4 Identify what you will pay special attention to in order to assist your team and the organisation to reach the desired state, psychological safety and live the organisation vision and purpose.

- Increase visibility within the team of the different projects we are working on and the purpose and value thereof. This aids in information sharing and creating a common thread or goal that the team is working towards. It also aids in boosting collaborative efforts across the board. I

aim to take the lead on this.

- Taking a more proactive role in gaining feedback and recognition from product owners. Continuous feedback is critical to fostering team identity and realizing our value to the organization. The feedback surveys provide an avenue to doing this

2. PSYCHOLOGICAL SAFETY (THEME 2)

2.1 Leadership behaviours - write a short paragraph on each indicating how you:

2.1.1 Became a visible and present leader

I proactively identified key team challenges that could be addressed through the Psychological Safety initiative and took ownership of driving change. I ensured continuous engagement by actively monitoring the initiative's progress, facilitating discussions, and creating accountability within the team. By being approachable and consistently present- whether through one-on-one check-ins, team meetings, or leadership discussions- I reinforced a culture of openness and trust.

2.1.2 Became a brand ambassador (lived the brand)

I embodied the organization's values by championing collaboration, innovation, and inclusivity in all aspects of my work. Through my advocacy for psychological safety, I reinforced Vodacom's commitment to fostering a supportive and high-performing work environment. I also actively promoted the organization's vision by ensuring that our team's ways of working aligned with its broader strategic goals, demonstrating my commitment both internally and externally.

2.1.3 Articulated the organisations visions to your team

I facilitated regular engagement sessions with my syndicate team and leadership to align our initiatives with the organization's vision. I clearly communicated how fostering psychological safety directly contributes to Vodacom's objectives of innovation, collaboration, and excellence. By breaking down strategic goals into actionable steps, I ensured that my

team understood not just what we were aiming for, but why it mattered- encouraging buy-in and commitment.

2.1.4 Lived the leadership behaviours

I demonstrated empathy, assertiveness, and strategic thinking throughout the initiative. I remained attuned to my team's needs, balancing flexibility with accountability to ensure that everyone could contribute meaningfully while managing their workloads. I also worked to secure stakeholder buy-in, advocating for the initiative's benefits and reinforcing our team's value to the organization. By maintaining a solutions-focused mindset, I fostered trust, encouraged open discussions, and ensured that psychological safety became more than just a concept—it became part of our team culture.

2.1.5 Created Psychological Safety (refer 2.2 for your project inclusion)



Treading Quicksand

NEML Psychological Safety Initiative

Pamela Afful

Contents

1. Project Purpose and Theme
2. NEML Team and Syndicate Overview
3. The Pit in Question
   - Current Psychological Landscape of the NEML Team
   - Pre-Initiative Syndicate Team Sentiment
4. Key Team Pain Points
5. The Escape Plan
   - Product Owner Survey Initiative
   - Framework: Engendering Team Psychological Safety and Value Through Stakeholder Feedback
   - Key Psychological Safety Touchpoints
5. Survey Questions
4. Product Owner Survey Results
   - Overall Results
   - Project Fit and Relevance
   - Progress and Implementation Satisfaction
   - Overall Team Satisfaction
5. Post-Initiative Syndicate Team Sentiment
6. Conclusion: Initiative Future Plans

Project Purpose and Theme



Purpose

To engender and promote psychological safety and value in the Network Engineering and Machine Learning Team through a documented Product Owner survey feedback mechanism.



Theme

The team decided that the loose use of **quicksand** (including the treading and eventual escape of it) as a metaphor was the aptest theme to encapsulate the current state of our team from a psychological safety point of view.

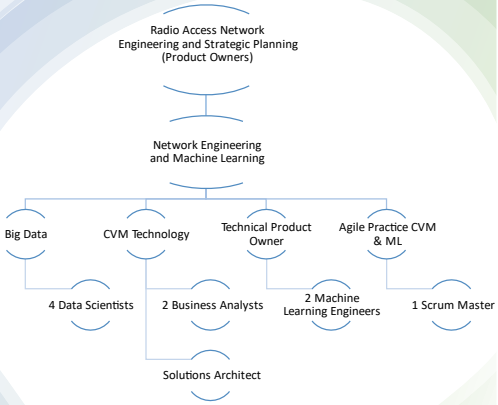


NEML Team Overview

The **Network Engineering and Machine Learning Team (NEML**) supports the Network Specialists and Operations team, our **Product Owners (POs),** by creating data artifacts for network planning and optimization. We leverage data to extract insights and develop models that enhance and optimize the Vodacom Network.

The team has a diverse technical skill set, including data scientists, business analysts, solution architects, and machine learning engineers located across three cities: Johannesburg, Stellenbosch, and Cape Town. The majority of the team is based in Johannesburg, with two members in Stellenbosch and one in Cape Town.

In addition to the product owners we serve, various departments and line managers oversee different subgroups within the team. This creates a more complex hierarchy for the team compared to similar teams**. For this pilot initiative, the syndicate team consisted of 3 data scientists and 2 business analysts.**



Project Syndicate Team



Pamela Afful- Data Scientist



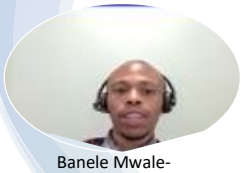
Tsholofelo Manamela- Data Scientist



Mashapa Rathebe- Data Scientist



Molebogeng Maboya- Business Analyst



Banele Mwale- Business Analyst

Current Psychological Landscape of the NEML Team



Working in the NEML space can often feel like navigating through a complicated, earthy quagmire. Team members, especially data scientists and business analysts, often have a limited understanding of the value of their efforts and how they impact our product owners and the wider organization. This lack of perspective makes it challenging for them to communicate the significance of their work and its implementation to their respective line managers and departments



The NEML team has created channels for members to discuss their accomplishments and challenges during each sprint. However, these discussions often remain limited to the team bubble, resulting in frustration and disengagement. This is often due to the unavailability of key decision-makers who can address the team's concerns.



However, moving forward, there is an opportunity for improvement with a more collaborative and accountable approach to addressing team concerns through a simple, documented approach.

The Pit in Question...

Pre-Initiative Syndicate Team Sentiment

The team experiences **frustration and a sense of powerlessness** due to their limited influence over their work. They face conflicting directives from departmental leadership and product owners, which **creates confusion** about project goals and how they align with the organization's vision. Additionally, there is a **disconnect** between the team members' skills and the tasks they are assigned, leaving them feeling undervalued. Despite these challenges, **the camaraderie and collaboration** among team members remain strong.



Key Team Pain Points

Psychological Safety Pain Point	Explanation
Lack of Collaboration and Unified Goals	Our current structure operates in silos, limiting collaboration and the sharing of ideas. This segmented approach prevents us from aligning on a shared objective, which diminishes overall team synergy and goal orientation
Limited Autonomy and Overbearing Top-Down Influence	Team members often feel constrained by decisions and expectations from higher management. This sense of restriction raises fundamental questions about our purpose and role within Big Data.
Misaligned Responsibilities and Evaluation Metrics	Many team members take on tasks beyond their primary roles, such as data scientists working in machine learning engineering. Additionally, performance evaluations often fail to accurately reflect our contributions, creating a disconnect between our work and its assessment.
Misaligned Stakeholder Expectations	There is a lack of clarity and alignment in the expectations of various stakeholders, leading to confusion and inefficiency as we try to meet divergent goals.
Lack of Recognition	The team's efforts are not sufficiently acknowledged, and internal clients often receive credit, diminishing team visibility within the organization.

Framework: Engendering Team Psychological Safety and Value Through Stakeholder Feedback

It is crucial that the team feels that they're valued through the work they produce. This should not be just another checkmark exercise but rather practical, strategic outcomes that empower team members to create an environment where they see their input is integrated into real decisions.

By getting coherent tangible feedback from product owners on the work we do and the value thereof, team members get a sense of identity and alignment - we aren't just cogs in a wheel but significant components to the fulfilling of the objectives of the Network team and Vodacom as a whole.



Key Psychological Safety Touchpoints



Team Touch Point	How the initiative aims to improves it
Lack of Collaboration and Unified Goals	Sentiment surveys measure product owners' views on the team's collaboration and goal alignment. This feedback highlights communication gaps and fosters discussions to create a unified vision, promoting proactive collaboration and team synergy.
Limited Autonomy and Overbearing Top-Down Influence	Surveys can help product owners assess the team's decision-making autonomy. Positive feedback indicates progress, while negative feedback reveals areas where top-down pressures hinder effectiveness. This information allows team members to advocate for clearer boundaries to enhance their independence.
Misaligned Responsibilities and Evaluation Metrics	Feedback from product owners about the team's effectiveness can reveal mismatches with stakeholder needs. This helps leadership clarify roles, ensure proper specialization, and align evaluation metrics with actual contributions, leading to a more accurate assessment of team performance.

Key Psychological Safety Touchpoints (cont.)



Team Touch Point	How the initiative aims to improves it
Misaligned Stakeholder Expectations	Surveys gather product owners' expectations and satisfaction, helping the team identify aligned or diverging goals. Regularly reviewing this feedback clarifies expectations, communicates priorities, and aligns efforts with stakeholder needs, reducing confusion and enhancing efficiency.
Lack of External Recognition	Sentiment surveys can show if product owners value their teams' contributions. Highlighting this feedback in reviews increases visibility and helps ensure that positive recognition is included in organizational narratives.

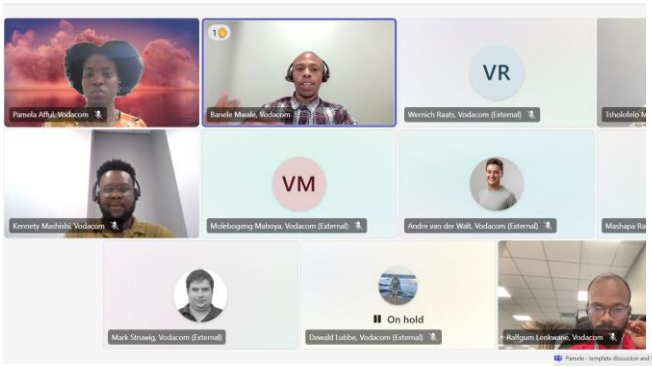


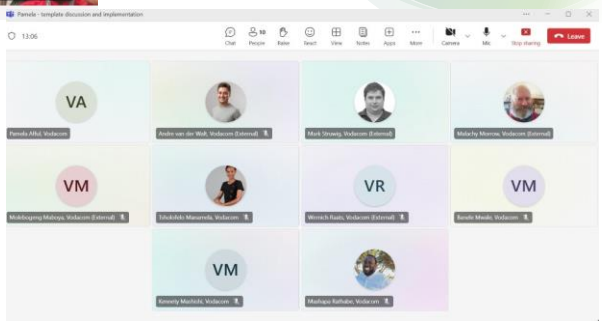
Key Initiative Leadership Challenges

The biggest challenge was generating interest among my peers to participate in the initiative. There was a prevailing sense of detachment and helplessness within the syndicate team regarding our role in the broader NEML team. My main challenge was to encourage enthusiastic engagement from the team, particularly in a virtual environment.

Time posed another challenge. I needed to emphasize the importance of this initiative and how it could benefit the team in the long run. Therefore, we had to carve out specific time dedicated to working on this project. I also had to be sensitive and flexible to my peers' schedules.

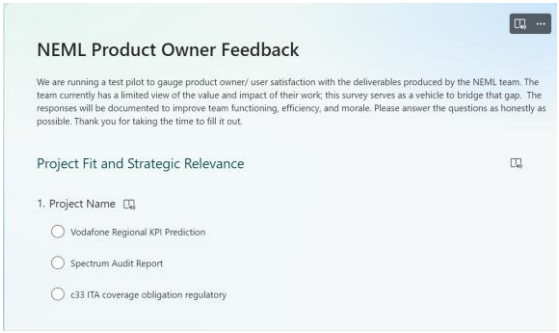
Securing support from senior leadership and external stakeholders was essential. I aimed to integrate the survey into our workflows and present it effectively to our internal clients. Additionally, it was important to ensure that the survey frequency was manageable for the Product Owners (POs) to gather valuable feedback.

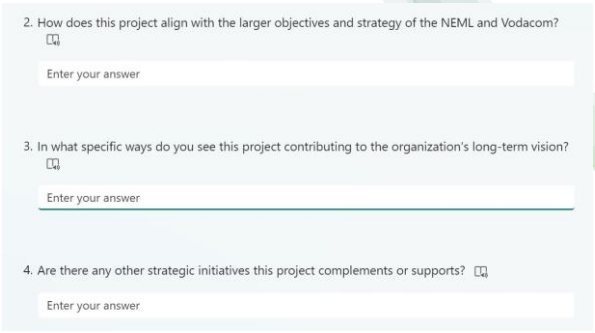




Psychological Safety Team Sessions

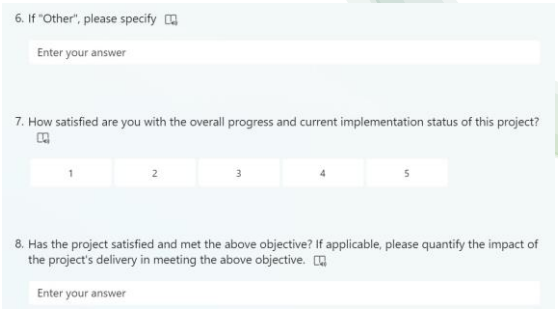
PO Survey Questions

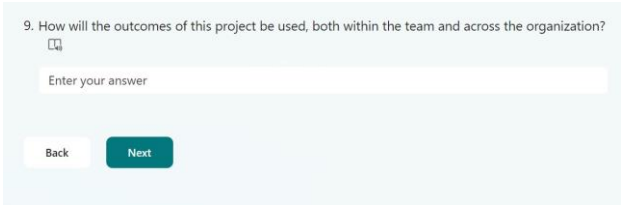




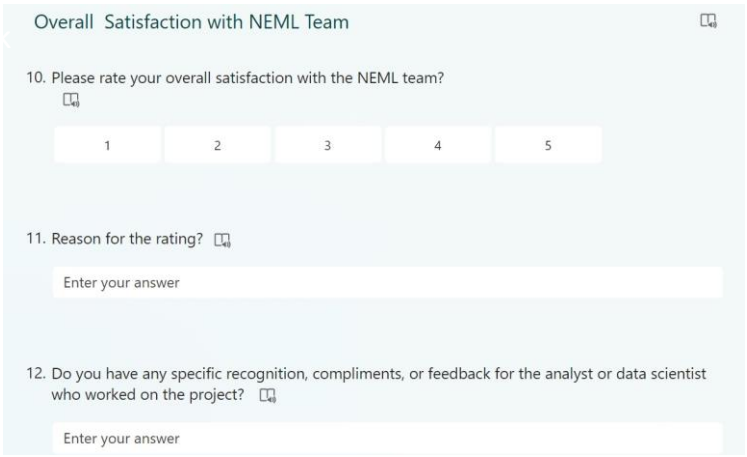
PO Survey Questions (cont.)







PO Survey Questions (cont.)



Overall Satisfaction with NEML Team

10. Please rate your overall satisfaction with the NEML team?

1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5

11. Reason for the rating?

Enter your answer

12. Do you have any specific recognition, compliments, or feedback for the analyst or data scientist who worked on the project?

Enter your answer

Survey Results

Overall Results

2024/12/02 09:49

Yes, Carmen. I received it. Thank you very much for taking the time to complete it. Just out of interest, could this be something that your team is open to doing for our team going forward i.e after the completion of a project, the respective PO can answer/rate their satisfaction with the project? We want to increase our team's visibility/view regarding the impact of the projects we work on. Especially since we also have to give Nkuli a rundown of the value of our projects, we'll have something to reference.

Carmen Kyzer, Vodacom 2024/12/02 09:56

CT i think so, that way we can also share our learnings and best ways to tackle similar projects going forward

however the product owners might not always have the capacity to do it but im sure they will try to make time

The overall results from the pilot surveys reported an overall positive sentiment from POs toward the team's work.

Although we got two out of three responses, there is evidence that this initiative can be a useful mechanism to document and reference the team's key successes, and ways to improve and quantify value and impact.

One product owner noted that the initiative could also be a useful avenue to " share our learnings and best ways to tackle similar projects going forward."



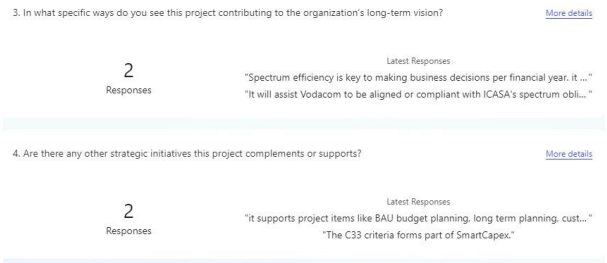
C2 General

Survey Results (cont.)

Project Fit and Relevance

- Product owners provided a detailed overview of how our projects align with and contribute to the key objectives of the Networks team and Vodacom as a whole.
- This helps team members understand how our work contributes to the short, medium, and long-term vision of our team and the wider organization.





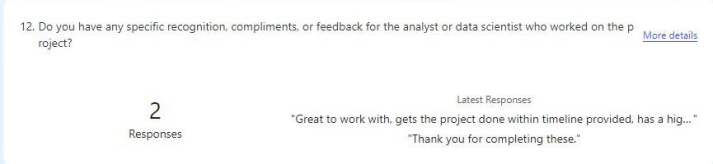
Survey Results (cont.)

Overall Team Satisfaction

- The product owners provided feedback on their overall satisfaction with the team's functionality, as well as comments on the specific team member who worked on the project.
- This fosters a sense of security and pride for team members, while also providing the chance to receive critical feedback that can be applied to future projects.





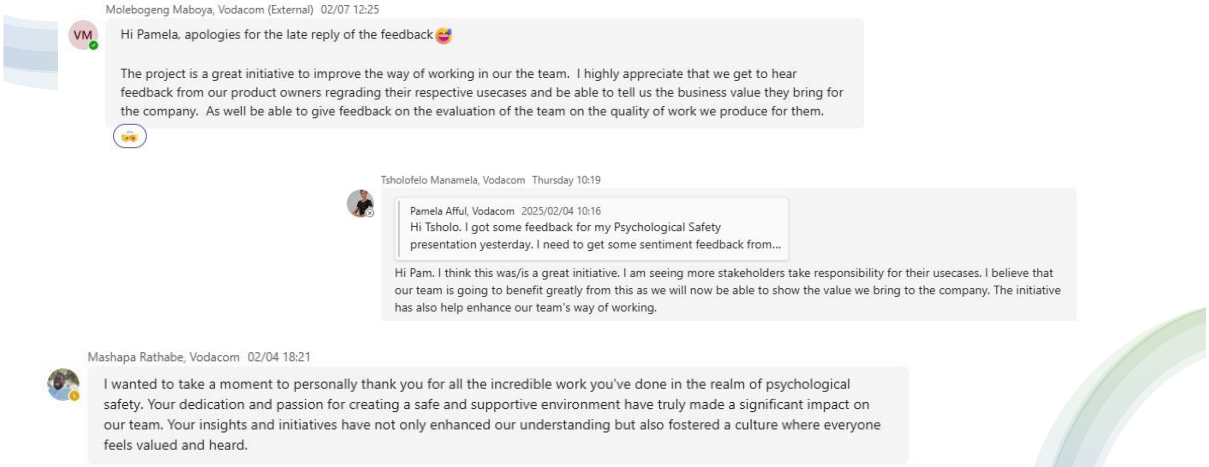


Post-Initiative Syndicate Team Sentiment

- The syndicate team's feedback on the survey results was overwhelmingly positive, highlighting its value as a tool for reflection, recognition, and alignment. Team members appreciated the survey as a well -designed mechanism for gathering feedback, noting its ability to provide a sense of **identity, purpose, and recognition** within the Big Data team. However, they expressed a desire for more detailed insights, such as **the measurable impact of their work in terms of time or effort saved.**
- The initiative engendered feelings of **appreciation, confidence, and clarity** about stakeholders' perceptions, while also **reducing stress and promoting a results-oriented mindset**. Looking ahead, team members emphasized the importance of securing **greater stakeholder participation and senior leadership** support to ensure the initiative becomes a consistent and impactful part of the team's way of working.



Post-Initiative Syndicate Team Sentiment cont.



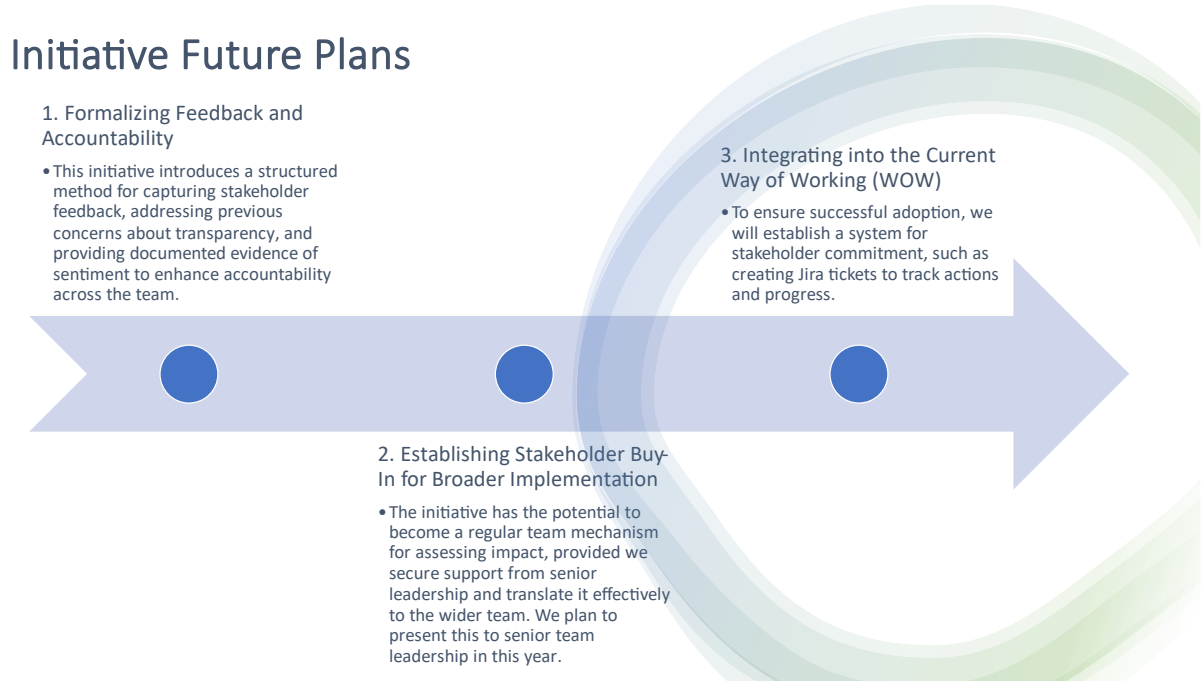
Team Sentiment: Psychological Safety Touchpoints

Touchpoint	Did the initiative improve this?	Sentiment
Lack of Collaboration and Unified Goals	Yes	There is still room for improvement but the survey gives the team an expanded view to which business goals we are working toward creating a sense of team identity and pride.
Limited Autonomy and Overbearing Top-Down Influence	No	Authority still is concentrated outside the team, but the initiative has helped us have a documented reference that we can use to advocate for ourselves and our work.
Misaligned Responsibilities and Evaluation Metrics	Yes	The survey captures and documents key satisfaction metrics that are well-understood by all parties involved.

C2 G

Team Sentiment: Psychological Safety Touchpoints

Touchpoint	Did the initiative improve this?	Sentiment
Misaligned Stakeholder Expectations	Yes	The survey sets and documents stakeholder expectations which we are able to track and benchmark against.
Lack of External Recognition	Partly	There is still room for improvement as the initiative is still in its infancy, but the is definite potential for the surveys to be used as consideration factors for recognizing and rewarding the value that the team produces.



Conclusion: Leadership Pledge

I pledge to be a steadfast advocate for Psychological Safety within my team, regardless of my role as a peer, leader, or follower. I will contribute to creating an environment where every team member feels valued, respected, and heard, ensuring that diverse perspectives are welcomed and acknowledged. I will celebrate both personal and team successes with humility, recognizing the contributions of others while remaining sensitive to their needs. Additionally, I will use my abilities and influence to support my team through challenges, proactively working to ease difficulties and foster a culture of trust, collaboration, and continuous growth.

2.2 Individual psychological safety project

2.2.1 Title – **Treading Quicksand**

2.2.2 Project purpose- To improve team psychological safety within the Network Engineering and Machine Learning Team through stakeholder engagement and feedback.

2.2.3 Actions planned and taken: We initiated a pilot product owner project survey initiative. We send surveys to product owners to give us feedback on the quality of the work we have produced as well as gauge their overall sentiment towards the team.

2.2.4 Deliverables- Sample completed feedback surveys from product owners who we deliver projects for.

2.2.5 How experienced by followers

- The syndicate team's feedback on the survey results was overwhelmingly positive, highlighting its value as a tool for reflection, recognition, and alignment. Team members appreciated the survey as a well-designed mechanism for gathering feedback, noting its ability to provide a sense of identity, purpose, and recognition within the Big Data team.

- The initiative engendered feelings of appreciation, confidence, and clarity about stakeholders' perceptions, while also reducing stress and promoting a results-oriented mindset.

2.2.6 Feedback by followers

- My syndicate team agreed that they want this initiative to be implemented and integrated into our team's way of working.
- We agreed we need to define a way of getting stakeholders to commit to this and create Jira tickets for them. It will also help us keep track the progress of the completion of these surveys.
- In addition to all the above, this initiative ensures that we have a formal way of getting feedback. Previously, it seemed like stakeholders were not happy with what we were doing. Now we have documented proof of stakeholder sentiment. We are all accountable.

BIASES (THEME 7)

Refer to the strategies contained in the articles "what works for women at work maternal wall bias" and "what works for women at work tightrope bias" and identify strategies that you will employ, capture in your journal and poe the team advantages as well as your strategies.

Strategies for Overcoming Maternal Bias:

- Although I do not have children, I will strive to challenge my subconscious bias toward mothers that I work with in my team. I will try to be understanding of their situations and practice patience in dealing with them
- I strive to adjust the way I communicate and be sensitive and challenging of the assumptions I make of mothers. I will make an effort to understand the unique challenges that working mothers may face, such as balancing caregiving responsibilities with work demands. I will consciously use inclusive language that avoids making assumptions about someone's priorities or capabilities based on their parental status.
- I will also be respectful of people's time, particularly the time they set aside to deal with personal issues without mentally penalizing them or setting up a mental expectation of their commitment to work. I will trust mothers to manage their responsibilities effectively. I will trust them to do the same for me as a childfree professional woman.

Strategies for Overcoming Tight Rope Bias:

- Effective, balanced use of both "masculine" and "feminine qualities", embracing a blend of traditionally "masculine" qualities (e.g., assertiveness, decisiveness) and "feminine" qualities (e.g., empathy, collaboration) based on the context of my work.
- Regularly assess which qualities are most effective for specific situations, leveraging them to my advantage.
- Network and promote my work. Get people who can sponsor and vouch for me. Proactively seek out mentors, sponsors, and allies who can provide guidance, advocate for my work, and help me navigate biases.

- Be assertive in stating my opinion but still be respectful and considerate of people I interact with in whatever capacity.

4. COMMUNICATION (THEME 10)

4.1 Presentation of your learning to your own team.

Do it with slides of your own design capturing your own learning journey



Introduction

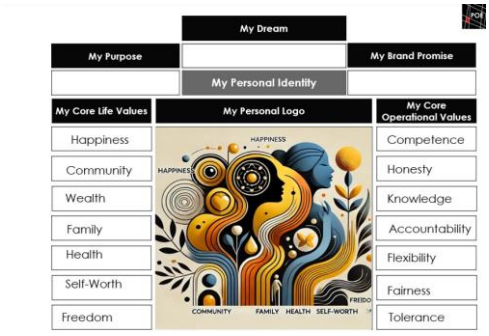
The purpose of this presentation is to give the team an overview of the key insights and learnings I have gained over the past six months of participating in the Women Who Lead (WWL) leadership development program.

My presentation will broadly cover the following themes:

PROJECT ME: My key "ah- ha" moments from the program - what I discovered about myself	PROJECT US: Psychological Safety and Team Identity	PRACTICAL APPLICATIONS: Key benefits to our team

Project ME
My Personal Development Journey

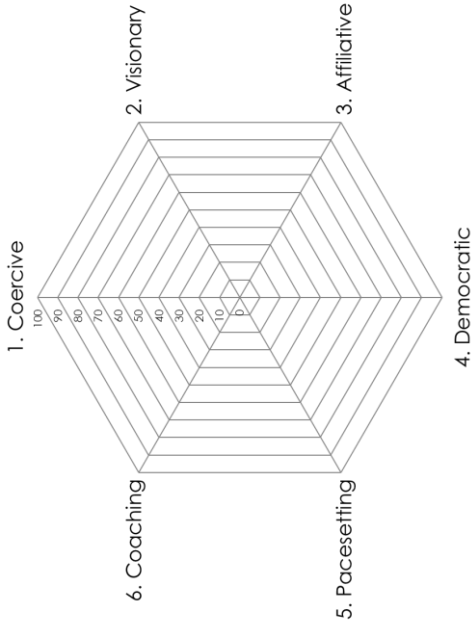
- This part of the program is primarily around my self - discovery and how this best relates to me as an effective leader.
- The two most significant themes that I found enlightening in my leadership self - discovery are the following:
  1. **Discovering and Assessing my Key Personal Values** : This involved me taking a critical look at the values that an important to me and what fuels my ambition. The journey from what I initially thought was important to what I ended up with was pleasantly surprising and insightful. I was able to summarize these core life and operational values as well as how these feed into **My Purpose, My Dream,** and **My Brand Promise**



My purpose: My purpose is to cultivate a life of joy, connection, and fulfilment, grounded in a strong sense of self-worth.
My dream: My dream is to live a fulfilled, complete life where I am a part of a strong, close-knit community.
My brand promise: My brand promises to live authentically, travel, and gain new experiences and perspectives. I aim to be a cultured person.

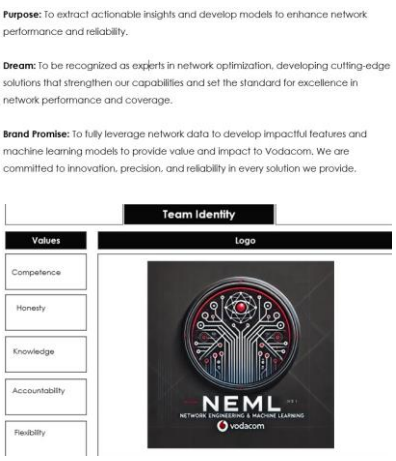
Project ME
My Personal Development Journey (cont.)

2. **Discovering my leadership styles and areas I can capitalize off of and improve:** Through this, I was able to comprehensively gauge the way I relate with authority within my team as well as my peers. I learnt that I tend to lean adopt a Democratic Style of leadership but I should still be cognizant of the risk of being too aggregable to the point it impedes productivity. I also identified that I would like to build and nurture my competencies in **Coaching** and **Visionary** leadership styles
   - I also identified key personal changes I would like to make, including embracing authenticity as well as improving my accessibility to my peers and junior members of the team. I also aim to take a more a more active interest in the in the work of my colleagues to further reinforce my presence in the team.



Project US
Psychological Safety and Team Identity

- This area of the program focused on bringing my team along my journey through the realm of engendering psychological safety.
- The most significant lessons I got from this area were:
  1. Psychological Safety is a journey, not a destination. It is iterative and can be continuously improved upon to ensure a more inclusive and safe environment for all.
  2. The Psychological Safety initiative in particular highlighted the specific needs and shortcomings of the team in fostering safety but allowed the team to bring on external stakeholders onto the journey.
  3. I also reflected and assessed the team's identity and values we deem important to the core of who we are as a team . We are a team built on respect, accountability, and a high level of knowledge and competency. As a potential leader and a peer, it is my responsibility to visibly live this out to the best of my abilities.


Purpose: To extract actionable insights and develop models to enhance network performance and reliability.

Dream: To be recognized as experts in network optimization, developing cutting-edge solutions that strengthen our capabilities and set the standard for excellence in network performance and coverage.

Brand Promise: To fully leverage network data to develop impactful features and machine learning models to provide value and impact to Vodacom. We are committed to innovation, precision, and reliability in every solution we provide.

Team Identity

Values	Logo
Competence	NEML – Network Engineering & Machine Learning – vodacom
Honesty	
Knowledge	
Accountability	
Flexibility	

Key Benefits to Team

On the whole, my participation in the leadership program has been beneficial to the team in the following ways:

The adoption of the Product Owner Feedback Survey initiative has strengthened the team's sense of identity by gathering valuable stakeholder insights. This feedback has allowed us to refine our ways of working and continuously improve our collaboration.

Enhanced interpersonal relationships: I have become more visible and actively engaged with the wider team, fostering stronger connections and better communication. While there is still room for growth in this area, we are making significant progress in the right direction.

Greater alignment on team goals and priorities: Through my leadership development, I have helped facilitate clearer discussions around our objectives, ensuring that everyone is aligned and working toward a shared vision. This has improved team cohesion and focus.

Conclusion: Leadership Pledge

Within the team: I will work within my team to champion a data- driven culture, fostering an environment empowered to extract actionable insights from network data. Importantly will work to promote a collaborative environment where I am more visible and accessible. I will continue to share my knowledge and expertise and play a role in empowering us to become recognized experts in the field.

Impactful Delivery for stakeholders: I will ensure every solution we deliver leverages network data to its fullest potential, translating raw information into impactful features and valuable machine learning models. I will prioritize innovation, demand precision and accuracy, and foster accountability to ensure the reliability and effectiveness of our work, ultimately maximizing the value and impact we bring to Vodacom.

4.2 TEAM EVALUATION FORMS

Presenter: Pamela Afful

Evaluated by: Tsholofelo Manamela **Position: Data Scientist**

Date: 11/02/2025

	Could Improve	No Problem	Strong Feature
First impression: What impression did you get during first two minutes?			
Good smiling, eye contact and confidence		X	

Strong, confident introduction		X	
Opening: Was it captivating, clear and structured?			
Was the opening captivating?		X	
Does it have a purpose and an agenda?			X
Is the benefit for the audience clear?	X		
Message: Are simple main points supported with strong persuasive elements?			
Are the main points clear?		X	
Is the delivery persuasive and memorable?			X
Are the audience benefits referred to?	X		
Does it progress smoothly and logically?			X
Ending: Is the ending powerful and memorable? Yes			
Does it have clear call to actions?	X		
Does it have summary of main points?	X		
Is the purpose of presentation achieved?		X	
Body language: Does body language support the verbal message?			
Any distracting mannerisms and/or gestures?			X
Was the vocal pitch, tone and pace appropriate?			X
Was eye contact balanced?		X	
Audience engagement: How well does the presenter engage the audience?			
High energy and passion for topic?		X	
Good audience handling (inc. questions)?		X	
Smiling appropriately to engage audience?		X	
Other Notes: did any other strengths stand out?			
Content: Did you experience that the presenter truly learned about leadership?		X	
Authenticity: Was the presenter 'real and authentic?'			X
Vulnerability: How did the presenter show vulnerability?			X

Evaluated by: Banele Mwale Position: Business Analyst Date: 11/02/2025	Could Improve	No Problem	Strong Feature
First impression: What impression did you get during first two minutes? Presenter was confident and articulate			
Good smiling, eye contact and confidence		X	
Strong, confident introduction		X	
Opening: Was it captivating, clear and structured? Yes. The topic was clearly stated			
Was the opening captivating?		X	
Does it have a purpose and an agenda?			X
Is the benefit for the audience clear?	X		
Message: Are simple main points supported with strong persuasive elements? Some points could've been removed as they felt like filler content			
Are the main points clear?		X	
Is the delivery persuasive and memorable?			X
Are the audience benefits referred to?	X		
Does it progress smoothly and logically?			X
Ending: Is the ending powerful and memorable? Yes			
Does it have clear call to actions?	X		
Does it have summary of main points?	X		
Is the purpose of presentation achieved?		X	
Body language: Does body language support the verbal message?			
Any distracting mannerisms and/or gestures?			X
Was the vocal pitch, tone and pace appropriate?			X
Was eye contact balanced?		X	
Audience engagement: How well does the presenter engage the audience?			
High energy and passion for topic?		X	
Good audience handling (inc. questions)?		X	
Smiling appropriately to engage audience?		X	
Other Notes: did any other strengths stand out?			
Content: Did you experience that the presenter truly learned about leadership?		X	
Authenticity: Was the presenter 'real and authentic?'			X
Vulnerability: How did the presenter show vulnerability?			X

Evaluated by: **Molebogeng Maboya** **Position: Business Analyst**
Date: 11/02/2025

	Could Improve	No Problem	Strong Feature
First impression: What impression did you get during first two minutes? Presenter was confident and articulate			
Good smiling, eye contact and confidence			X
Strong, confident introduction			X
Opening: Was it captivating, clear and structured? Yes. The topic was clearly stated			
Was the opening captivating?			X
Does it have a purpose and an agenda?			X
Is the benefit for the audience clear?		X	
Message: Are simple main points supported with strong persuasive elements? Some points could've been removed as they felt like filler content			
Are the main points clear?			X
Is the delivery persuasive and memorable?			X
Are the audience benefits referred to?	X		
Does it progress smoothly and logically?			X
Ending: Is the ending powerful and memorable? Yes			
Does it have clear call to actions?	X		
Does it have summary of main points?	X		
Is the purpose of presentation achieved?		X	
Body language: Does body language support the verbal message?			
Any distracting mannerisms and/or gestures?		X	
Was the vocal pitch, tone and pace appropriate?		X	
Was eye contact balanced?		X	
Audience engagement: How well does the presenter engage the audience?			
High energy and passion for topic?			X
Good audience handling (inc. questions)?			X
Smiling appropriately to engage audience?		X	
Other Notes: did any other strengths stand out?			
Content: Did you experience that the presenter truly learned about leadership?		X	
Authenticity: Was the presenter 'real and authentic?'			X
Vulnerability: How did the presenter show vulnerability?			X

5. HIGH-PERFORMANCE INDIVIDUAL ASSESSMENT OF TEAM MEMBERS

(THEME 11)

5.1 Include the 'high-performance individual assessment of team members' document of all your followers in your POE.

1. Not relevant/ cannot rate 2. Hardly ever 3. Seldom
4. Sometimes 5. Often 6. Most of the time

NAMES:		Banele Mwale						Tsholofelo Manamela						Mashapa Ratebe					
PERFORMANCE BEHAVIOUR																			
Whole		1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6
1.	A well-balanced, integrated person						X					X							X
2.	Integrates and balances work and personal life						X					X						X	
Results-centred																			
3.	Remains focused on the end result in the work being done						X						X						X
4.	Consistently delivers completed, high standard work						X						X						X
Appropriate conduct																			
5.	Behaves in line with the values and the norms of the organisation						X						X						X
6.	Conduct demonstrates professionalism						X						X						X
Enthusiastic																			
7.	Shows a lively interest in own work as well as the work of others					X						X						X	
8.	Eagerly participates in organisational challenges and goals						X						X						X
Team-oriented																			
9.	Behaves in a way that shows that the team is more important than self						X					X							X
10.	Uses the language of 'we' and 'the team' more than 'me' and 'my work'						X				X							X	

1. Not relevant/ cannot rate 2. Hardly ever 3. Seldom
4. Sometimes 5. Often 6. Most of the time

NAMES		Banele Mwale						Tsholofelo Manamela						Mashapa Ratebe					
Relationship competent		1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6
11.	Focuses on building strong and trusting relationships with others at work	X						X						X					
12.	Builds networks across the organisation	X						X						X					
Personal leader																			
13.	Takes personal leadership in own role, independent from appointed leader					X						X						X	
14.	Displays a mind-set of 'I am in the first instance a leader of myself'					X						X						X	
Self-developing																			
15.	Takes responsibility for own learning and growth	X						X						X					
16.	Constantly acquires relevant knowledge and valuable new skills					X							X					X	
SCORES: PERFORMANCE BEHAVIOUR																			
FOLLOWERSHIP																			
Self-managing																			
17.	Performs independently of performance management systems and controls				X						X								X
18.	Safe for leader to delegate responsibilities to						X					X							X
Committed																			
19.	Shows commitment to the organisation that goes beyond own needs	X						X						X					
20.	Helps leader to stay on track by pointing out pitfalls, problems and risks						X				X							X	
Courageous																			
21.	Admits own mistakes and takes accountability for it	X						X						X					
22.	Speaks mind independently					X				X							X		

1. Not relevant/ cannot rate 2. Hardly ever 3. Seldom
4. Sometimes 5. Often 6. Most of the time

NAMES		Banele Mwale						Tsholofelo Manamela						Mashapa Ratebe					
Relationship with leader		1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6
23.	Seeks and encourages feedback from leader					X						X						X	
24.	Candid and respectful with leader						X						X						X
Creative																			
25.	Challenges existing practices and methods with new ideas				X					X							X		
26.	Improves on own work processes through new approaches	X						X						X					
Change mind-set																			
27.	Accepts and even initiates change willingly				X				X							X			
28.	Participates positively in change initiatives however challenging				X					X							X		
SCORES: FOLLOWERSHIP																			
LEADERSHIP BEHAVIOUR																			
Principled																			
29.	Shows a deep commitment to the values of the organisation evidenced by expectations of others' behaviour	X						X						X					
30.	Consistently ethical						X						X						X
Consistent																			
31.	Consistent in judgement and in making decisions	X						X						X					
32.	Consistent in behaviour; reliable					X					X						X		
Engaging																			
33.	Values views of others even if different from own views						X						X						X
34.	Engages others and ensures their active support						X						X						X

1. Not relevant/ cannot rate 2. Hardly ever 3. Seldom
4. Sometimes 5. Often 6. Most of the time

NAMES		Banele Mwale						Tsholofelo Manamela						Mashapa Ratebe					
Inspirational		1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6	1	2	3	4	5	6
35.	Reveals approachability and humanity by exposing some personal vulnerabilities	X						X						X					
36.	Supports people to connect their daily activities to the brand promise	X						X						X					
SCORES: LEADERSHIP BEHAVIOUR																			
INTELLIGENCE																			
Emotional																			
37.	Understands own emotions and moods and their impact on others	X						X						X					
38.	Controls emotions under challenging circumstances					X							X						X
39.	Has a passion to work for reasons that go beyond money and status	X						X						X					
40.	Is skilled at treating people according to their emotional reactions	X						X						X					
41.	Proficient in managing relationships and building networks	X						X						X					
Cultural																			
42.	Demonstrates sensitivity towards the diverse cultures of people					X						X						X	
SCORES		14	0	0	4	8	15	14	1	3	4	9	11	14	0	1	4	6	13
TOTAL HIGH-PERFORMANCE INDIVIDUAL SCORE		41						42						37					

5.2 After assessing your full team, identify patterns in attributes, dimensions, and categories common to all low or all high performers. present these patterns to your team and agree with them the actions that will be included in your team development plan. include the plan in your POE.

Team development plan:

The team agreed that the core areas that we need to improve are the following:

- **Change mindset:** The team has faced significant leadership changes in recent months, which has resulted in some resistance to change.
    - Action Plan:
        - To combat this, we have bi-weekly alignment sessions where we work through key team challenges and discuss how we can best address them going forward and improve our team synergy. We will strive to share success stories of past adaptations, and gather feedback from colleagues to address concerns proactively.

- **Improve our team visibility and relationship-building:** The team operates somewhat in isolation from the broader Big Data Team, limiting collaboration and recognition of accomplishments.

    - Action Plan:
        - To combat this we will make a concerted effort to participate in the wider departmental showcases and knowledge sessions every quarter.
        - We will also identify and initiate at least one cross-functional project per quarter with other teams to foster interdepartmental relationships.
        - Use insights from the Product Owner Feedback Survey to identify high-impact projects and celebrate wins. Explore patterns in feedback to guide future initiatives.

- **Team creativity:** Although our team is highly technical, we conceded that there is room to foster more creativity and innovative thinking.
    - Action Plan
        - Daily 'Did-You-Know?' Segments: Continue incorporating these short, knowledge-sharing moments into daily stand-ups to spark curiosity and knowledge exchange from the interesting tidbits we learned from our ongoing projects.
        - We also agreed that it would be beneficial to allocate some time each quarter for team members to work on creative side projects or explore new tools and techniques.

6. JOINT ACCOUNTABILITY (THEME 12)

6.1 Reflect on relationships, trust and candour within your team. Capture in your journal the actions that you will take as follows: my team leadership and team strengths that i will use more to improve on the above, my leadership and team deficiencies that i will share with my team and start doing something about.

- **My team leadership and team strengths that I will use more to improve on the above:**
    - My leadership strengths lie in **Results and Accountability,** as well as the **Commitment** pillars; qualities that complement each other well. I take full ownership of my actions and work, ensuring that I always give my best effort, particularly when my contributions impact others or key stakeholders.

      I strive to be the "captain of my ship," steering my efforts toward the best possible outcomes for both myself and those around me. As a results-oriented leader, I always seek the "so what" in every task, decision, or project I undertake. My focus on tangible outcomes enables me to allocate resources effectively, ensuring the greatest value and impact. This approach allows me to excel as a team member, peer, and leader, fostering a collaborative and high-performing environment.

    - Changes to personal life: I will work with intention and resolve by setting clear, tangible goals that promote both professional and personal growth.

      I will also strive to maintain accountability by leveraging the support of friends and mentors who help keep me aligned with my personal development goals and objective

    - Changes to work life: I will aim to lead by example by demonstrating self-accountability, setting a standard for ownership and responsibility.

      I will work to cultivate a team ecosystem of accountability, ensuring that both the quality of work and its impact align with the team and

Vodacom's broader goals. I will do my part to encourage a results-driven mindset where every team member understands the value of their contributions in achieving collective success.

- **My team leadership and team deficiencies I will share with my team and start doing something about.**
    - My primary areas for growth in leadership fall within the Conflict and Trust pillars. I often struggle with having difficult conversations in both my personal and professional life, opting for avoidance rather than addressing issues directly. This makes it harder for me to fully trust that others will uphold their responsibilities, leading me to take on more work than I should. As a result, this impacts collaboration and prevents me from fostering mutual trust with my peers. Over time, this dynamic can lead to feelings of resentment, reduced efficiency, and a lack of harmony within my team. Additionally, I sometimes struggle to trust myself enough to take calculated risks or challenge existing processes, which can hinder my professional growth and development

    - Changes to my personal life: I will make a concerted effort to be more assertive in advocating for myself, ensuring that I express my needs and concerns rather than suppressing them for the sake of perceived harmony. I will work on developing the confidence to engage in difficult conversations, recognizing that open communication fosters stronger relationships and more authentic connections. By embracing discomfort in the short term, I can build deeper trust in both my personal and professional interactions.

    - Changes in work life: I will set clear expectations with peers and stakeholders regarding key decisions and project outcomes to create alignment and mutual accountability. By clearly defining responsibilities and deliverables, I can minimize miscommunication and uncertainty, ultimately promoting a more collaborative and trusting team environment. Additionally, I will encourage myself to step outside of my comfort zone by embracing constructive conflict

as a means for growth, understanding that well-managed disagreements can lead to improved solutions and foster innovation.

7. TEAM DEVELOPMENT (THEME 12)

7.1 Completed form

This assessment activity enables team members and the team leader to review their overall effectiveness by focusing on a number of factors that are important to the success of teams. There are sixty statements on the pages that follow. Your job is to indicate the extent to which you agree or disagree with each statement, entering the reply on the separate answer sheet.

Some of the statements will be characteristic of the team you are a member of. Others will not be. Please place a circle on the answer sheet in the box that best reflects your own opinion of each statement.

- If you definitely agree, place a circle around the two plus signs. (++)
- If you are inclined to agree, place a circle around the one plus sign. (+)
- If you are inclined to disagree, place a circle around the one minus sign. (-)
- If you definitely disagree, place a circle around the two minus signs. (- -)

E.g.:

No.	Personal rivalries are fairly common around here	+ +	+	-	- -

Notice that in the sample item above, there is a circle around the box that indicates the person responding is inclined to agree. As you go through this list of 60 items, place a circle in one of the four boxes for the corresponding number on your answer sheet for each item.

After completing the activity, you will be given instructions on how to score your responses and interpret the results.

You may want to invite other members of your team to go through the activity. By comparing your responses and arriving at a composite score or average for the group, you will be able to identify the team's strengths and the areas where your effectiveness is being blocked. This should lead to a discussion by members and the leader as to what actions can be taken to improve the team's overall effectiveness.

++	definitely agree
+	inclined to agree
-	inclined to disagree
--	definitely disagree

1.	The leader usually discusses issues with the team, and gets their opinion before making decisions	+ +	+	-	- -
2.	Sometimes our work suffers because one or more team members lack the ability to handle the situation	+ +	+	-	- -
3.	Our members are well committed to the purpose and objectives of the team	+ +	+	-	- -
4.	The team needs to spend more time clearing the air of suspicion and distrust among certain members	+ +	+	-	- -
5.	The organisation does not make intelligent use of our organisation's talent	+ +	+	-	- -
6.	Our team meetings are productive and we get a lot accomplished	+ +	+	-	- -
7.	Some of our people don't know how their own roles relate to the jobs of other team members	+ +	+	-	- -
8.	Being a member of our team provides me with a great deal of satisfaction	+ +	+	-	- -
9.	We receive frequent and specific feedback on our work	+ +	+	-	- -
10.	Our team lacks a good programme for developing its members	+ +	+	-	- -
11.	The leader is not flexible enough and does not easily adapt to the needs of others	+ +	+	-	- -
12.	Some members are not adapting to the needs of others or to the goals of the team	+ +	+	-	- -
13.	In practice, the team often falls short of its objectives	+ +	+	-	- -
14.	Our team members are good at working out interpersonal problems and in dealing with one another with openness and candour	+ +	+	-	- -
15.	Our team's objectives have not been integrated into the objectives of the entire organisation	+ +	+	-	- -
16.	At our team meetings, decisions we reach and plans we agree to are often not followed up or acted upon	+ +	+	-	- -
17.	We have regular reviews of individual and group objectives	+ +	+	-	- -
18.	There are other teams here at work that would be more satisfying to belong to	+ +	+	-	- -
19.	Our team members learn well from mistakes and from feedback we get from others	+ +	+	-	- -
20.	Our team members have many opportunities for growth and expansion of their skills and knowledge	+ +	+	-	- -
21.	Team members do not know where they stand with the leader	+ +	+	-	- -
22.	Our team spends a lot of time and energy getting the right members and developing them effectively	+ +	+	-	- -
23.	Members have a good record of stretching themselves to accomplish the team's mission	+ +	+	-	- -
24.	Our team members haven't really gotten to know one another very well as individuals	+ +	+	-	- -
25.	Our team works with a clear mission that is known to members and outsiders alike	+ +	+	-	- -
26.	Our team members lack a methodical approach to working together in meetings	+ +	+	-	- -
27.	We have a long way to go to improve communication between and among team members	+ +	+	-	--

++ definitely agree

+ inclined to agree

- inclined to disagree

-- definitely disagree

28.	Some of our members are not very satisfied with the way things are going in our team	+ +	+	-	- -
29.	We presently lack the ability to review our effectiveness in a constructive, objective manner	+ +	+	-	- -
30.	Little time and effort is spent on individual development and training	+ +	+	-	- -
31.	The leader welcomes leadership effort by other team members and encourages initiative	+ +	+	-	- -
32.	The mix of skills and abilities among our members is very well suited to producing high levels of performance	+ +	+	-	- -
33.	A lot of energy is absorbed in doing things that do not move us towards our team objectives	+ +	+	-	- -
34.	Our group tends to be frank and open, with members telling each other just how they feel	+ +	+	-	- -
35.	If our team were dissolved, the organisation would experience a substantial loss	+ +	+	-	- -
36.	We are pretty good at using team meetings to resolve conflicts, solve problems, and build commitment	+ +	+	-	- -
37.	Our team members have a good understanding how of how to use one another and the resources of the organisation	+ +	+	-	- -
38.	I am proud to be a member of our team	+ +	+	-	- -
39.	We do a good job of reviewing the team's performance and what we as individuals can do to improve it	+ +	+	-	- -
40.	Our team members have shown good initiative in developing themselves	+ +	+	-	- -
41.	The leader has done a good job of working with members to clarify their expectations and needs	+ +	+	-	- -
42.	Sometimes our team is viewed by outsiders as unqualified and inadequate	+ +	+	-	- -
43.	Team members rarely let personal interests interfere with the team's effectiveness	+ +	+	-	- -
44.	Internal backbiting, politics, and cliques sometimes interfere with the team's effectiveness	+ +	+	-	- -
45.	There is confusion between out team's work and work of others	+ +	+	-	- -
46.	I don't see much benefit from the team meetings I've attended	+ +	+	-	- -
47.	Our interpersonal relations among team members need improvement	+ +	+	-	- -
48.	Morale on our team is not what it should be	+ +	+	-	- -
49.	We tend to avoid feedback and critique	+ +	+	-	- -
50.	Many team members have had almost no individual development beyond their area of specialisation	+ +	+	-	- -
51.	The leader is not sensitive enough to the team's perceptions and ideas	+ +	+	-	- -
52.	Our team members are all good at handling their jobs	+ +	+	-	- -
53.	Some members do not have a strong sense of belonging to the team or identifying with its goals	+ +	+	-	- -

++	definitely agree
+	inclined to agree
-	inclined to disagree
--	definitely disagree

54.	We relate well as team members and have developed a healthy level of trust and openness	+ +	+	-	- -
55.	Our team's contribution is understood and respected by others with whom we work	+ +	+	-	- -
56.	We use our time effectively when we get together; very little time is wasted	+ +	+	-	- -
57.	We relate well to one another and have developed fairly effective ways of working together	+ +	+	-	- -
58.	Sometimes we fail to appreciate the many benefits of being a member of our team	+ +	+	-	- -
59.	Our reviews of team performance tend to rock the boat and end up jeopardising our working relationships	+ +	+	-	- -
60.	We've done a good job training and developing our team members	+ +	+	-	- -

LEADERSHIP AND TEAM DEVELOPMENT: ANSWER SHEET

Directions: Add up the six circled scores that appear side by side across the page. Be sure that you are adding horizontally (sideways), rather than in the usual vertical manner. The sum of these six scores reflects your views of your team's **leadership**. Enter the sum in the box to the right of the **leadership** scores.

Now do the same for each of the other nine horizontal groupings. Each score that you enter will be the sum of six circled numbers. The highest score possible is a 24; the lowest is a 6

| | | | | |

| | | |

4. **Building a climate of trust and openness** – A healthy level of trust and openness exists among team members. When interpersonal problems arise, they are dealt with candidly and honestly before they are allowed to disrupt the positive climate. Internal backbiting, politics, and cliques do not interfere with the team's effectiveness

5

5. **Clarifying the mission** - The organisation understands and respects contributions made by the team and would experience a substantial loss if the team did not exist. The mission of the team is integrated into the objectives of the entire organisation.

6

6. **Using meetings to build teamwork –** The time spent at meetings is used effectively in resolving conflicts, solving problems, and building commitment. The decisions reached and plans made are followed up and acted upon by members. Meetings are run using a methodical approach understood and supported by team members.

5

7. **Developing relationships** – Team members have developed fairly effective ways of working together and know how to use one another as resources. Members know how their roles relate to the roles and responsibilities of other team members. As the team develops, interpersonal relations among members are improved and strengthened.

5

8. **Cultivating job satisfaction –** members experience a great deal of satisfaction and pride in being part of the team and do not choose to belong to another team. Being a member of the team means receiving psychological (intrinsic) and financial (extrinsic) rewards. Team morale is high and stays that way even when problems arise.

5

9. **Improving the quality of feedback** – The team views mistakes as learning experiences. Team performance is reviewed in a constructive and objective manner. Members give and receive feedback and suggest how to improve team performance. Reviews of team performance do not end up jeopardising working relationships among members.

5

10. **Training and developing the team** – Team members have many opportunities for growth and enlargement of their skills and abilities within and beyond their individual areas of speciality. Members initiate self-development programs to benefit team performance.

59

11. Now add the numbers in the preceding ten boxes. A "perfect "score is 100. How well did your own team score? A score of 70 or less indicate that there is room for improvement. More important, you know which items to concentrate on – those with the lowest scores.

7. TEAM DEVELOPMENT (THEME 12)

7.2 Team development insights, learning and agenda

Our team clearly has significant room for improvement, as shown by below-average scores across nearly every area of the questionnaire. There are area for improvement in establishing ourselves as a high-performing, influential team. The strongest attributes of our team—productivity, membership, and openness—highlight the camaraderie, technical skills, and willingness to collaborate that already exists within our group. These strengths provide a solid foundation for improvement. However, critical issues have emerged:

- Sense of Belonging and Influence:
  Our team feels disconnected and lacks a meaningful sense of influence within the organization. This perception limits our confidence and impact on organizational goals.

- Job Satisfaction:
  General satisfaction with day-to-day work is low, despite external factors beyond the team's control contributing to this sentiment. It's imperative that we identify aspects within our control to foster greater satisfaction and motivation.

  Actions we can take

  - Foster a culture where team members feel psychologically safe to engage with internal clients by asking questions and seeking tangible, constructive feedback on deliverables. We will do this by leveraging the psychological safety initiative we piloted to reinforce trust and transparency within and outside the team.
  - Establish regular opportunities to showcase our contributions and successes across the organization, demonstrating the value we bring.
  - Organize activities that strengthen connections within the team, fostering collaboration and shared identity. Create mechanisms for team members to voice concerns and provide input on decisions that impact their work.

Team Agenda

- Monthly Strategy Sessions: Review progress on team goals, especially around influence-building and self-leadership. Share updates on feedback received from internal clients and use it to guide adjustments to our approach.
- Psychological Safety Check-ins: Host regular discussions focused on fostering trust, transparency, and open communication. We can also discuss and review results from product owner feedback surveys. We can also tie product owners into these check-ins to gauge perceptions of our contributions and identify areas for improvement.
- In addition to the above, we can develop and establish ways to enhance job satisfaction within our control. This may include advocating for resources or support from leadership to address external factors affecting satisfaction as well as providing opportunities for professional development and skill-building to align individual growth with team success.

8. WORKSTYLES (THEME 12)

8.1 Meet with your team and discuss the work style concept. Hand them a copy of the article. Share your own work style, ask them to identify their personal work styles for discussion at a separate meeting, at this meeting capture the team profile and debate your insights as well as how you will use it as a team.

During our team discussion on work styles, most members identified with either the **Guardian** or **Great Integrator** work styles. This was expected, given that we are all early in our careers and naturally gravitate toward structured, collaborative approaches that provide stability and clear direction.

Our shared work styles enable us to operate effectively within predefined frameworks, ensuring that we produce high-quality work that integrates seamlessly with Vodacom's broader systems. This structured approach fosters reliability, consistency, and teamwork- essential for delivering strong results.

Relying too heavily on the Guardian and Great Integrator styles limits our ability to think outside the box, experiment with new approaches, and drive innovation. Incorporating elements from other work styles- such as the bold vision of a **Pioneer** or the decisive action of a **Driver**- could enhance our creativity and problem-solving capabilities.

Moving forward, we aim to strike a balance by intentionally adopting aspects of these other styles when tackling challenges. This could involve brainstorming sessions to encourage more risk-taking, empowering individuals to take ownership of experimental projects, or seeking mentorship from colleagues who embody these traits. We can strengthen our team's adaptability whilst actively contributing to Vodacom's culture of continuous improvement.

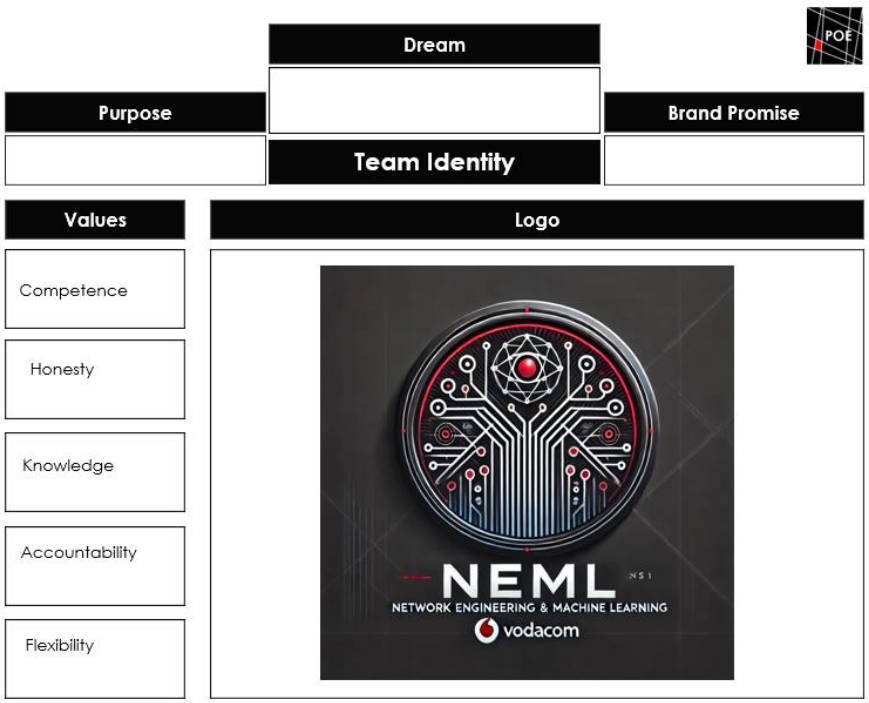
9. IDENTITY (THEME 13)

9.1 Team identity

Purpose: To extract actionable insights and develop models to enhance network performance and reliability.

Dream: To be recognized as experts in network optimization, developing cutting-edge solutions that strengthen our capabilities and set the standard for excellence in network performance and coverage.

Brand Promise: To fully leverage network data to develop impactful features and machine learning models to provide value and impact to Vodacom. We are committed to innovation, precision, and reliability in every solution we provide.



9.2 Reflection on team identity

My team embodies many of the attributes outlined in our vision, consistently collaborating to achieve our objectives and deliver valuable solutions. We take pride in our ability to develop impactful features and machine-learning models that enhance network performance and reliability. Our commitment to

innovation and precision ensures that we remain a trusted team for network-related data science projects, driving tangible improvements in Vodacom's network capabilities.

There is an opportunity for us to broaden our perspective beyond our immediate team goals. Although we execute our tasks efficiently, we sometimes lack a comprehensive view of how our work integrates with the broader objectives of the teams we serve. Strengthening our alignment with these stakeholders will enable us to create even more meaningful and strategic contributions, reinforcing our role as key players in Vodacom's data-driven decision-making processes.

Furthermore, we still have room for growth in becoming true data science experts within the Big Data department. We need to continuously upskill, embrace emerging technologies, and deepen our analytical capabilities. We can further solidify our reputation as leaders in network optimization. With a proactive approach to learning, we can set new standards of excellence and position ourselves at the forefront of data-driven network innovation.

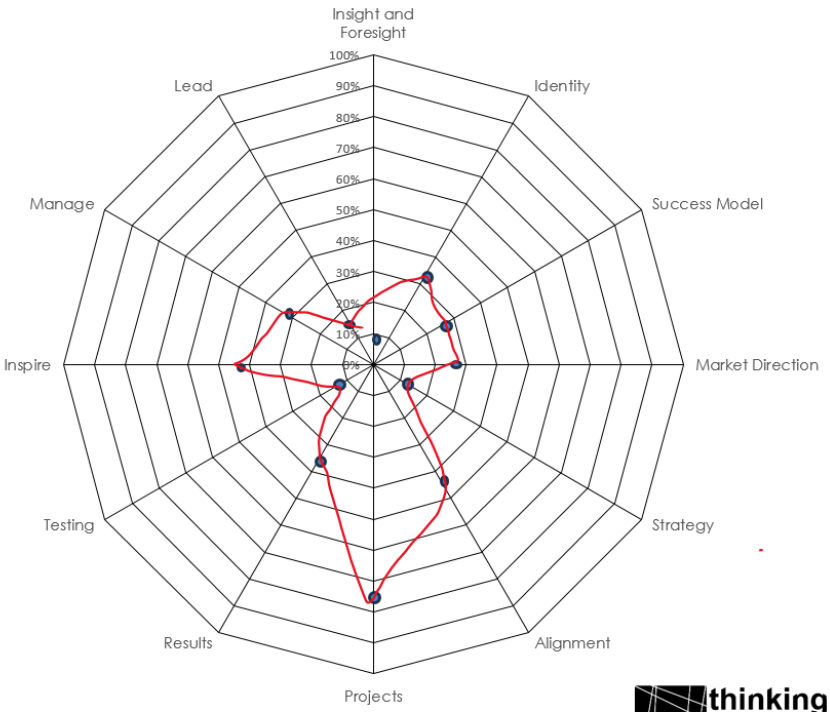
10. STRATEGY (THEME 13)

10.1 Assessment 3, include the final page (my priorities and actions) as well as your final self-assessment radar chart.

Giving Direction Self-Assessment

Name: Pamela Afful

	Percentage
Insight and Foresight	7.5
Identity	31.35
Success Model	25
Market Direction	25
Strategy	12.5
Alignment	45
Projects	75
Results	37.5
Testing	15
Inspire	33
Manage	21
Lead	16



10.2 Include the feedback you received from your team and how you will be responding to it

I have little influence over setting the macro strategy of Vodacom but still play a pivotal role in executing strategy over my zone of influence. The team suggested I work on the following areas:

- Attending more strategy meetings where senior leadership outlines the key objectives for the company in the upcoming year. This will give me deeper insight into the broader vision and help me position my work more effectively within the macro scope of the company.

- I could take a more influential role in the team by guiding junior interns in our team. This would be critical to making my presence more felt and significant in the team. This will also strengthen my leadership presence, contribute to

team development, and reinforce a culture of knowledge sharing.

- I will continue being results-oriented and proactively seek ongoing feedback from stakeholders. This will help track the impact of my work and demonstrate how it contributes to Vodacom's overall strategic goals.

PROJECT WE: 'DISSOLVING' COMPLEXITY

Zone of influence: team member

The ultimate aim of the programme is that leaders individually as well as collectively impact the organisation leadership culture in such a way that the organisation performs better and that it is a better place for people to be members of. The Connection economy requires new and different leader behaviours for leadership teams to excel in this environment. The following deliverables are required for this project:

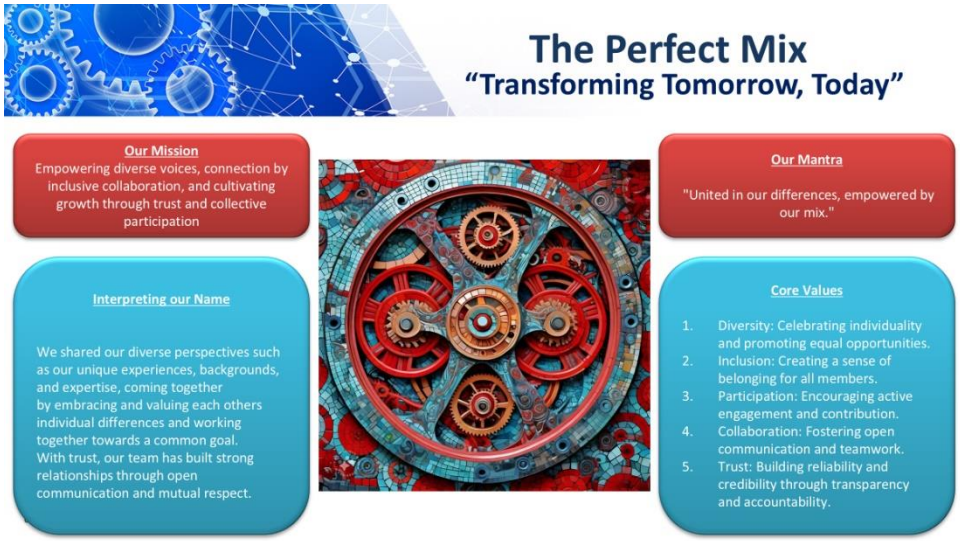
- **Presentation:** In your small group complete the project and the presentation ready to present to the group. Evaluation will be against the evaluation form. The facilitators will share a link with you for this. Based on the feedback a few will be selected to present to Exco. Include the project you participated in in your POE.
- **Leadership challenge:** Indicate the leadership challenge brough about by the 'messy' problem and what leadership challenges are faced by implementing the proposed 'solution'.
- **Leadership pledge:** You need to pledge your commitment to making the proposed projects work as well as how you promise to behave as leader in the future. Include this in your POE.
- **Design thinking**: Identify a design thinking project that your organisation requires, then build the foundation of a design thinking project using the template provided.

1. PRESENTATION (THEME 3)

In your small group complete the project and the presentation ready to present to the group. Evaluation will be against the evaluation form. The facilitators will

share a link with you for this. Based on the feedback a few will be selected to present to exco. Include the presentation of the project you participated in in your POE.





The Agenda

Get to know the Team	01
Understanding the Messy Problem	02
Systems Thinking Approach	03
Current vs Ideal Future	04
Strategies & Actions	05
Leadership Challenges	06

The Perfect Mix

"Transforming Tomorrow, Today"





thinking fusion AFRICA

NWU BUSINESS SCHOOL



Our purpose is to:



Transform the leadership culture in Vodacom from positional power & authority to a more inclusive, collaborative and trusting environment to promote staff morale, improve customer satisfaction and enhance business performance to continue being the number one leading Telco.



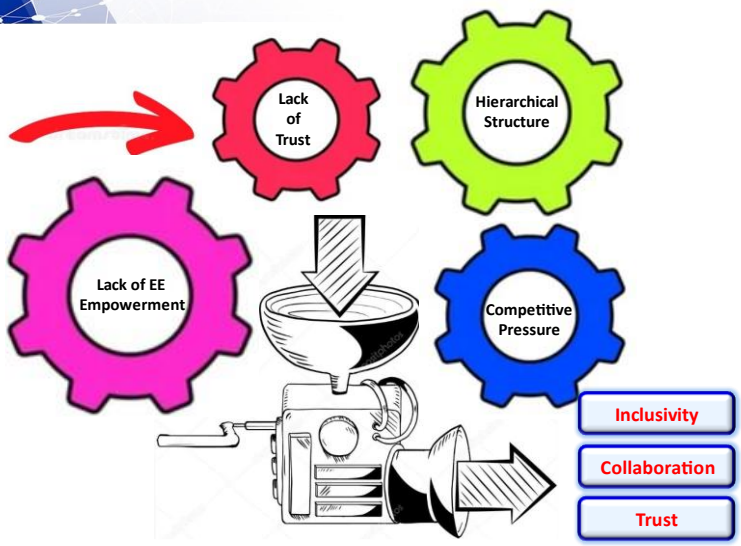
We achieve this by applying Systems Thinking methodology to dismantle hierarchies that obstruct transparent and cohesive communication and streamline processes through a structured, specialized approach. This enables us to produce high-quality submissions and thoughtfully reflect on our collaborative experiences throughout each assignment.

The "messy" Problem

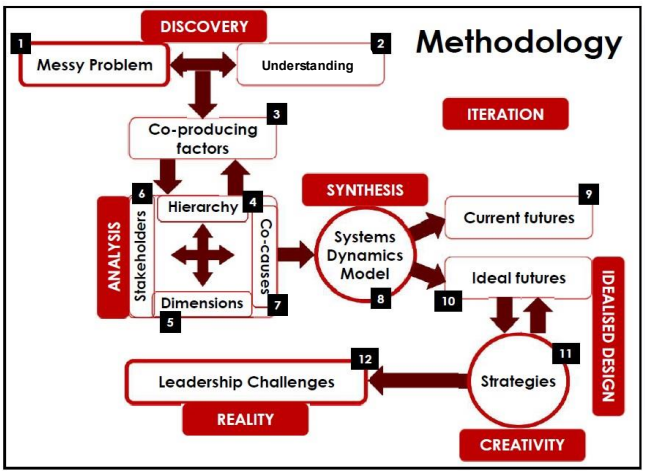
POWER IN EXPERTISE & RELATIONSHIPS

The leadership culture in VODACOM is strongly based on positional power & authority evidenced by hierarchical decision powers, top-down decision-making, resulting in slow feedback loops.

A further negative impact of this leadership culture is ineffective consequence management with excessive reliance on instilling processes as opposed to inclusivity, collaboration and creating trust across the hierarchies within VODACOM



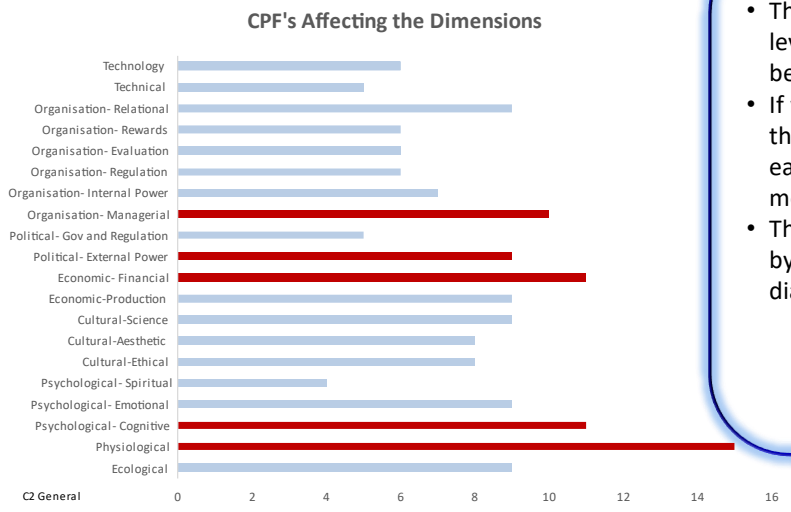
The Method



- The diagram represents the steps followed to dissolve the "messy problem"
- The process will
  - Identify Co-Producing Factors (CPF's)
  - Analyse the effects the CPF's have on each other and identify a set of Co-Causes
  - Using Systems Thinking, a model will be applied so that future models can be formulated
  - With strategies & action plans the ideal future steps will be developed
  - Change in leadership culture will steer us towards success

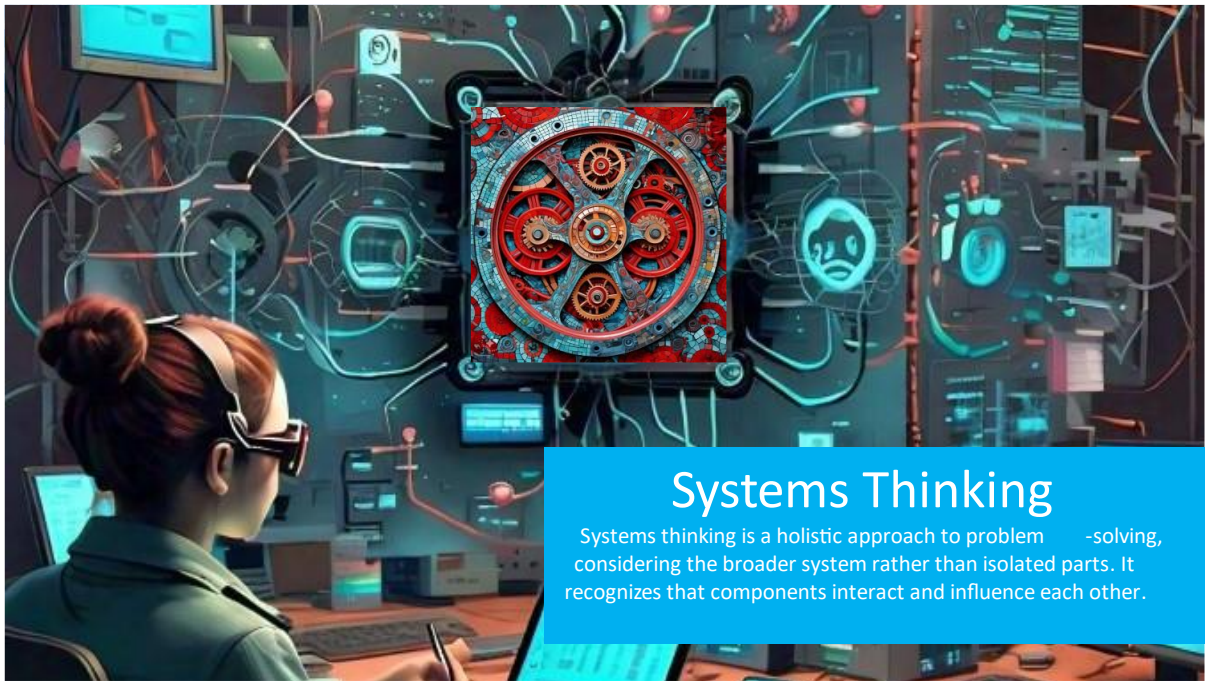
C2 General

Dimensions



NOTES

- The top CPFs impact almost all the levels of the organization (95%) to be exact.
- If we group dimensions according to themes they are associated with, each CPF impacts 1 or more dimensions within each theme
- The dimensions impacted the most by our CPFs as depicted by the diagram are
  - Psychological & Physiological
  - Economical
  - Political
  - Organizational



Systems Thinking

Systems thinking is a holistic approach to problem -solving, considering the broader system rather than isolated parts. It recognizes that components interact and influence each other.

Far From the Madding Crowd

Key Questions:

1. How can Vodacom shift from a hierarchical structure to inclusive decision -making?
2. What strategies can promote collaboration and trust across hierarchies?
3. How can leaders balance process adherence with employee empowerment?

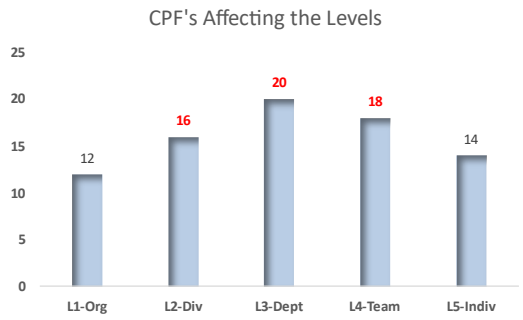


Potential Solutions:

1. Implement participative leadership models (e.g. serving leadership).
2. Foster open communication channels and feedback mechanisms.
3. Develop inclusive decision -making processes.
4. Empower employees through training and development programs.
5. Review and adapt organizational structure to promote collaboration.

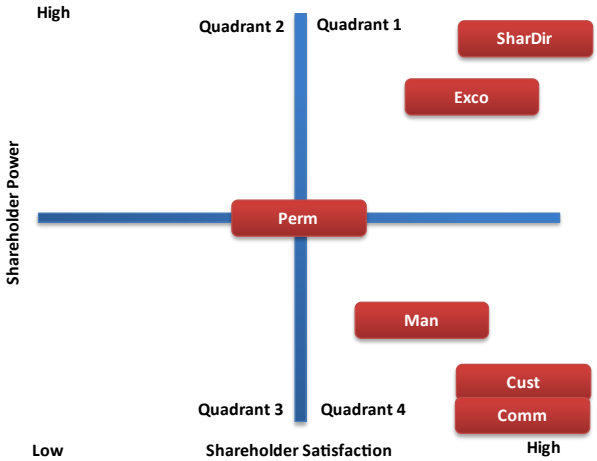
Hierarchies

L1 Org	Exco – Managing Directors & Chiefs of Business
L2 Div	ME – Managing Executives
L3 Dept	EHOD's – Executive Heads of Departments
L4 Team	Managers
L5 Indiv	People (US)



While the Co-Producing Factors (CPF's) exhibited across all levels, it had the most effect on Departmental and Team levels

Stakeholder Quadrants



NOTES

- **Quadrant 1**
  - Power & Satisfaction is highly indexed for Shareholders, Directors & Executive members
- **Quadrant 4**
  - Has low to no power due to control
  - Requires higher satisfaction

- Permanent Staff & Contractors have mid-range Power and support mid-range satisfaction



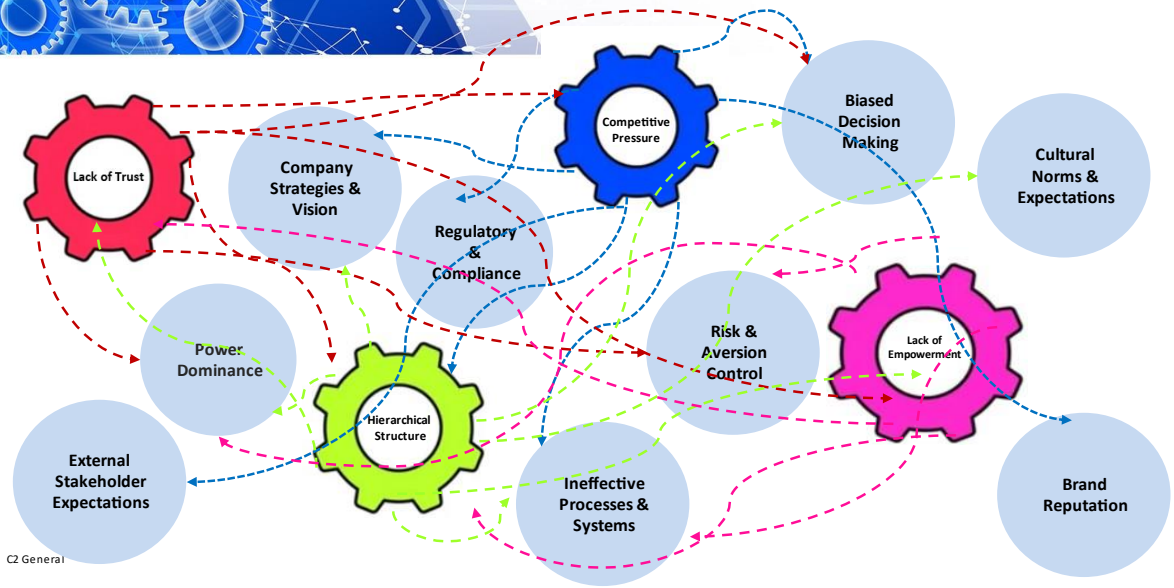
Systematic problems involve multiple Causations

(Sun Diagram Representation for Co-Producing Factors)





Systems Dynamic Model



C2 General

Leadership Challenges brought on by the Messy Problem



People

- Resistance to change by both leaders & employees
- Communication Barriers (top down approach) & Slow Decision Making
- Low Trust and Morale brought on by the messy problem



Accountability

- In a non-hierarchical structure, it might be harder to hold individuals accountable for their actions and decisions.



Conflict Management

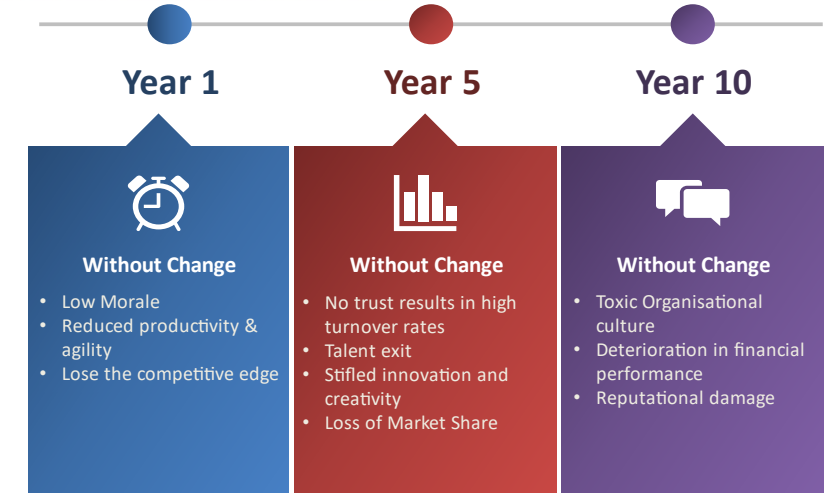
- With more people involved in decision-making, there could be an increase in conflicts and disagreements that need to be managed effectively.



Clarity & Direction

- Each team may interpret the problem differently compared to the other team, making it hard to formulate a clear solution to the problem.

Current Future



Current Future

Year 1	Year 5	Year 10
With Change • Employees feel motivated and improved trust • Speeds up decision making processes • Speedier responses to market demands	**With Change** • Psychologically safe environment with a greater talent pool • Fosters a culture of innovation • Quicker adaptation to market pressures	**With Change** • A culture of trust & empowerment • Innovation results in revenue growth • Industry leader and employer of choice

Ideal Future

- Employees empowered in decision making and problem solving
- Attract and retain Top Talent
- Freedom to Innovate and take calculated risks
- Quicker employee maturation
- Improved Psychological Safety



Strategies & Actions



Building and maintaining Trust

Leadership Challenges

Build a culture of trust, transparency & open communication where employees feel empowered, valued and confidence in leaderships decision

Desired State

- Implement regular team-building activities
- Introduce new communications channels where Employees can voice their opinions
- Introduce Coaching Programs

Action Plan

C2 General

Strategies & Actions



Delays in Communication or Communication gaps & Departmental conflicts

Leadership Challenges

Cultural shift from hierarchical to collaborative leadership

Desired State

- Reassess leadership roles- Leaders must assume more facilitative roles, nurturing an environment where ideas flow freely.
- Create leadership training opportunities to focus on changing mindsets.

Action Plan

C2 General

Strategies & Actions



Managing Conflict

Managing Diversity and inclusion

Maintaining consistent employee engagement

Leadership Challenges

Cultivate employee potential through autonomy, accountability & support, fostering a culture of innovation, ownership & growth

Desired State

- Create more opportunity for Recognition and Rewards
- Refresh employee development programs
- Regular feedback sessions to become mandatory

Action Plan

Strategies & Actions



Coping with stress and pressures of the environment.

Balancing Strategic Thinking and Execution

Leadership Challenges

Establish ourselves as the market leader through innovation, agility & customer - centricity, while maintaining a competitive edge & sustainable growth

Desired State

- Identify key competitors, market trends & needs of the customer
- Launch new products / services
- Introduce companywide product training for all employees

Action Plan

Leadership Challenges in Implementing the Solution



Mindset Shift

- Consistent application and significant time and effort is required to shift the deeply ingrained hierarchical culture and mindset
- Securing buy-in from senior leaders to adopt and model new behaviours.



Shifting Hierarchical Culture

- Significant effort & time required



Securing Leadership Buy-In

- Senior leaders need to adopt and model new behaviours



Ensuring Consistency

- Apply the new culture across all departments

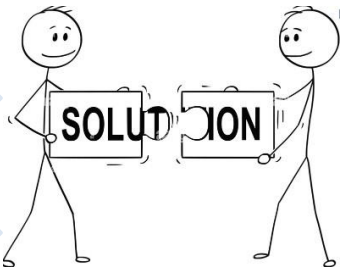
C2 General



In summary, our proposed solution will not only address the complex problem but…….

Will also foster a culture of engagement, collaboration, and customer - centricity, setting us apart from competitors and driving business success

By empowering employees and aligning our organization around customer needs, we will transition from a functional mindset to a holistic approach, delivering exceptional service. Implementing our solution will transform our organization, cultivating a culture of collaboration, innovation, and customer focus



This shift will differentiate us from competitors , solidify our market leadership, and establish us as the premier Mobile Telecommunications Provider in Southern Africa

By engaging employees' hearts and minds, we will drive business excellence

C2 General



Building Accountability, TOGETHER!

C2 General

2. LEADERSHIP CHALLENGE (THEME 3)

Indicate the leadership challenge brought about by the 'messy' problem and what leadership challenges are faced by implementing the proposed 'solution'.

The leadership challenges from our messy problem fell under the following broad areas:

1. People:
    - Resistance to Change – Both leaders and employees may struggle to adapt to a less rigid structure, fearing loss of control or clarity.
    - Communication Barriers & Slow Decision-Making – The existing top-down approach limits open dialogue, leading to delays in decision-making and feedback loops.
    - Low Trust & Morale – Employees feel disengaged when they lack influence over decisions that affect them. Trust in leadership diminishes, impacting overall morale and performance
2. Accountability
    - A non-hierarchical structure might make it harder to hold individuals accountable for their actions and decisions- creating uncertainty about roles, responsibilities, and ownership of decisions

3. Conflict Management
    - With more people involved in decision-making, more voices in decision-making, which could lead to heightened conflict if not managed effectively.

4. Clarity & Direction
    - Different teams may interpret the problem and proposed solutions differently, making it difficult to align on a clear path forward.
    - Without structured guidance, teams might struggle to transition from a hierarchical model to a more inclusive leadership approach.

Leadership Challenges in Implementing the Solution to the messy problem fell under the following broad areas:

1. Mindset Shift
    - Consistent application and significant time and effort is required to shift the deeply ingrained hierarchical culture and mindset

2. Securing buy-in from senior leaders to adopt and model new behaviours.
    - Significant effort & time required to persuade and ensure buy-in and sponsorship from senior leadership although some leaders could view this as a threat to their roles and influence. Careful consideration will be needed to balance the two.

3. Shifting Hierarchical Culture
    - Significant effort & time required to persuade participation and adoption of the new culture change- positing the change as the opportunity to further incorporate employee voices into the direction of the company

4. Ensuring Consistency
    - Consistent application of the new culture across all departments to ensure predictability and reliability.

3. MY LEADERSHIP PLEDGE (THEME 3)

As a budding leader within Vodacom, I pledge the following:

Within the team: *I will work within my team to champion a data-driven culture, fostering an environment empowered to extract actionable insights from network data. Importantly will work to promote a collaborative environment where I am more visible and accessible. I will continue to share my knowledge and expertise and play a role in empowering us to become recognized experts in the field.*

Impactful Delivery for stakeholders: *I will ensure every solution we deliver leverages network data to its fullest potential, translating raw information into impactful features and valuable machine learning models. I will prioritize*

innovation, demand precision and accuracy, and foster accountability to ensure the reliability and effectiveness of our work, ultimately maximizing the value and impact we bring to Vodacom.

4. DESIGN THINKING (THEME 13)

Build the foundation for a design thinking project that you feel is necessary for your organisation.

1. Situation and/or problem

What is the SITUATION or PROBLEM that you are trying to address?

Power In Expertise & Relationships:

Vodacom's leadership culture is predominantly shaped by positional power and authority, resulting in a hierarchical decision-making process. This structure often creates slow feedback loops and limits agility in responding to business challenges. Additionally, it weakens consequence management, as rigid processes take precedence over fostering inclusivity, collaboration, and trust across all levels of the organization.

This leadership dynamic affects employee morale, engagement, and the ability to innovate, ultimately impacting Vodacom's long-term success.

2. Constraints

What are the CONSTRAINTS when trying to address the situation or problem?

- Minimal Disruption to Operations – The cultural shift should enhance Vodacom's existing strengths without compromising the quality of service for both internal and external clients.
- Sustaining Excellence While Driving Change – The initiative should build upon Vodacom's areas of excellence while strategically addressing weaknesses in leadership and collaboration.
- Leadership Readiness & Adoption – Gaining executive sponsorship and ensuring leadership commitment will be critical for success.

3. Objectives and outcomes

What are the OBJECTIVES and intended OUTCOME of the design challenge?

Our **objectives** cover the following

To transition Vodacom's leadership culture from one driven by positional power and authority to one rooted in inclusivity, collaboration, and trust. This shift will:

- Improve employee morale by empowering staff at all levels.
- Foster greater collaboration across teams.
- Enhance customer satisfaction by increasing agility and responsiveness.

The **intended outcome** is a work environment where employees, regardless of rank, actively contribute to decisions that impact them- resulting in a more engaged workforce, stronger cross-functional collaboration, and a leadership model that is more adaptable and innovative.

4. People

Who are the PEOPLE that you are trying to help? Whose problem are you trying to address?

We aim to help **permanent staff and contractors** who experience **mid-range power and influence**, yet bear the greatest burden of siloed, top-down decision-making.

Employees often feel disconnected from strategic decisions that impact their roles, leading to disengagement and reduced productivity. By addressing their challenges, we can create a more dynamic and empowered workforce.

5. Estimates

What are the ESTIMATED resources required for this design challenge

To successfully drive this transformation, the following resources are essential:

- Leadership Buy-in – Securing commitment from senior leaders to champion the shift.
- Leadership Training – Equipping leaders with the skills to foster an inclusive and collaborative environment.
- Policy & Process Adjustments – Reviewing and refining HR policies and performance management frameworks to support a culture of trust and shared decision-making.

6. Scope

Is there ample SCOPE to explore multiple alternatives to address the problem?

There is significant scope to explore alternative approaches to leadership transformation:

- Leveraging internal success stories- certain teams within Vodacom already demonstrate inclusive leadership and agile decision-making. These can serve as models for broader cultural change.
- Adopting industry best practices – Exploring leadership frameworks from high-performing organizations that prioritize collaboration and empowerment.
- Testing and Iteration – Running pilot programs to assess the effectiveness of different strategies before full-scale implementation.

7. Design challenge

Frame the problem statement into:

How might we transform Vodacom's leadership culture from one driven by positional power and authority to a more inclusive, collaborative, and trust-based environment- enhancing employee morale, customer satisfaction, and overall business performance to sustain Vodacom's position as a market leader?